Financial Secretary Manual

Knights of Columbus Tracking Platform

Offline print edition

Compiled 2026-10-25 from docs/FINANCIAL_SECRETARY_MANUAL.md

Knights of Columbus Tracking Platform — Financial Secretary Manual

Audience: the council Financial Secretary (FS).

Covers: the Financial Secretary Desk, payment requests, returned reports, donations and checks, receipts and Honorary Expenses, the roster and its imports, setup codes, the Supreme roster sync, Forms 1728 and 1295, and Church Disbursement Requests.

> **Open this manual from your desk.** The Financial Secretary Desk header has 📖 **Financial Secretary Manual (PDF)** and a **How do I…** search that answers from this manual only.
>
> Signing up, logging hours and taking donations are in the *Member User Guide*.

> **Numbering and shared tasks:** this manual numbers its own chapters from 1. A task that several officers do is printed word for word in the manual of each of those officers. A reference to a section in another manual names that manual. The manual map lists the chapters of all four officer manuals.

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- 1. Finances: the Financial Secretary's work
- 2. Members, setup codes, the Supreme roster sync and Supreme forms
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How to read a tutorial

Every tutorial starts with a **Prerequisite (who can do this)** line. The line states the access privilege that the task needs. Stop when your role is not on the line.

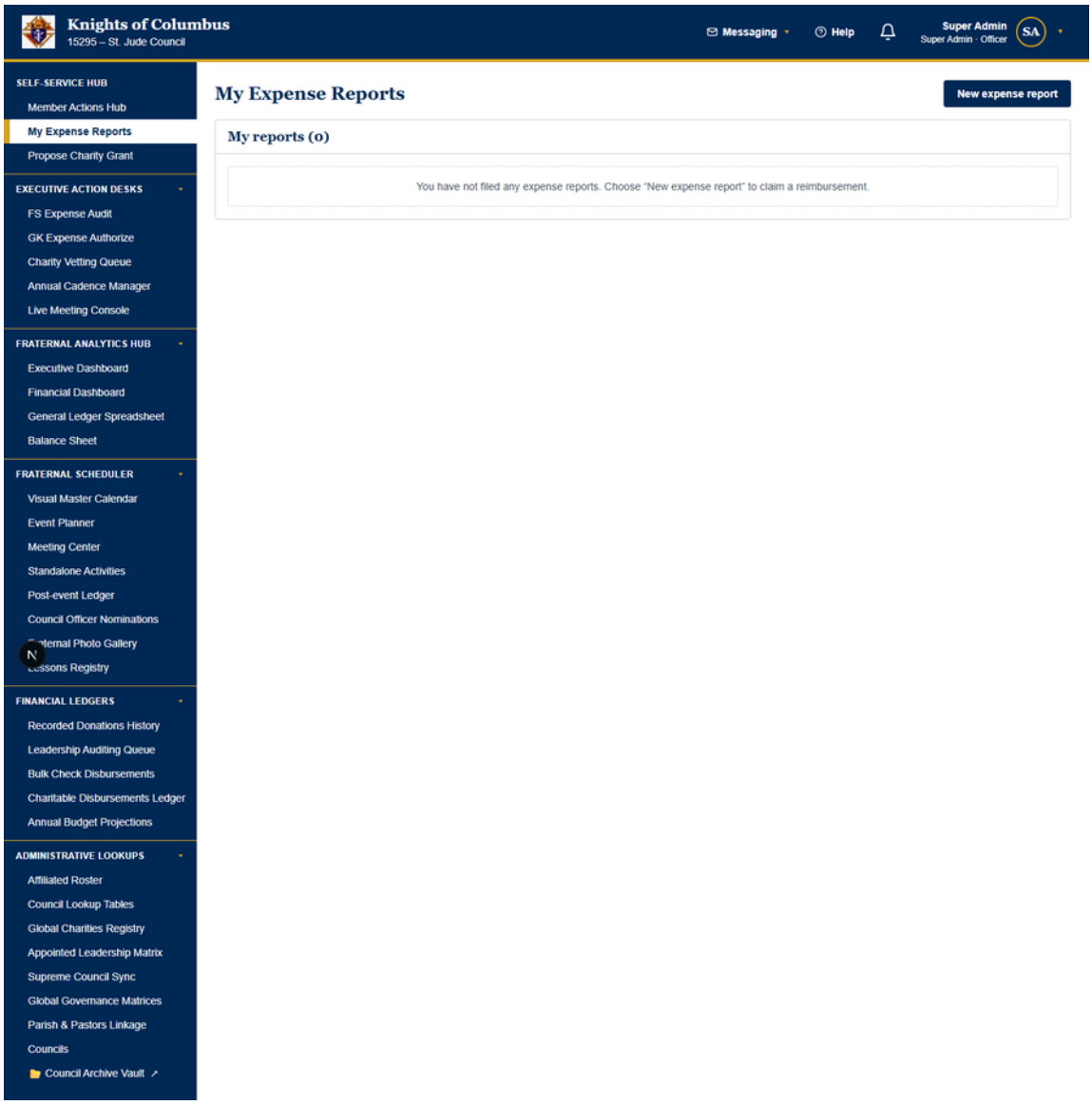
Every tutorial then has five parts: **Goal**, **Start point**, **Steps**, **Expected result** and **Common problems**. A **Warning** line comes before the steps when the task deletes data, sends messages, posts money or cannot be undone.

1. Finances: the Financial Secretary's work

1.1 Concept: the two-signature expense path

Step	Who acts	Where	Status tag
1. File	The member	**My Expense Reports**	**Submitted**
2. Payment request	The Financial Secretary	**FS Expense Audit** → **Verify & Sign Expense**	**RECORDED BY FS**
3. Categorize	The Treasurer	**Treasurer Ledger Audit Desk** → **Categorize & Lock Expense**	**CODED BY TREASURER**
4. Final release	The Grand Knight	**GK Expense Authorize** → **Final Release for Payment**	**Approved**
5. Pay	The FS or the Treasurer	**Bulk Check Payments Made**	**Reimbursed**
Return	Council leadership	**Leadership Auditing Queue** → **Reject & Return**	**Returned**

- A Super Admin may sign either line, but never both lines of the same report.
- Each signer chooses the budget line in **Assign Ledger Budget Line Item**. The report saves the line.
- The budget counts the report only against the saved line.
- The Treasurer chooses the ledger account before the Grand Knight signs. The account decides the budget line. A green line on the **Ledger Line Coder** names the line, for example **[Inferred Budget: Automatically Mapped to Monthly Council Meetings]**. **Categorize & Lock Expense** locks the account and the line.
- The officer who issued the order sees a **Collusion Guard** tag. That officer sees no **Final Release for Payment** button.
- Council Admins open both desks to follow the work. Only the seat holders or a Super Admin sign.
- A signer sees no button on a report the signer cannot sign. A tag tells who signs the report.
- A return clears both signatures and the saved budget line.



My Expense Reports (/expenses)

1.2 Issue a payment request

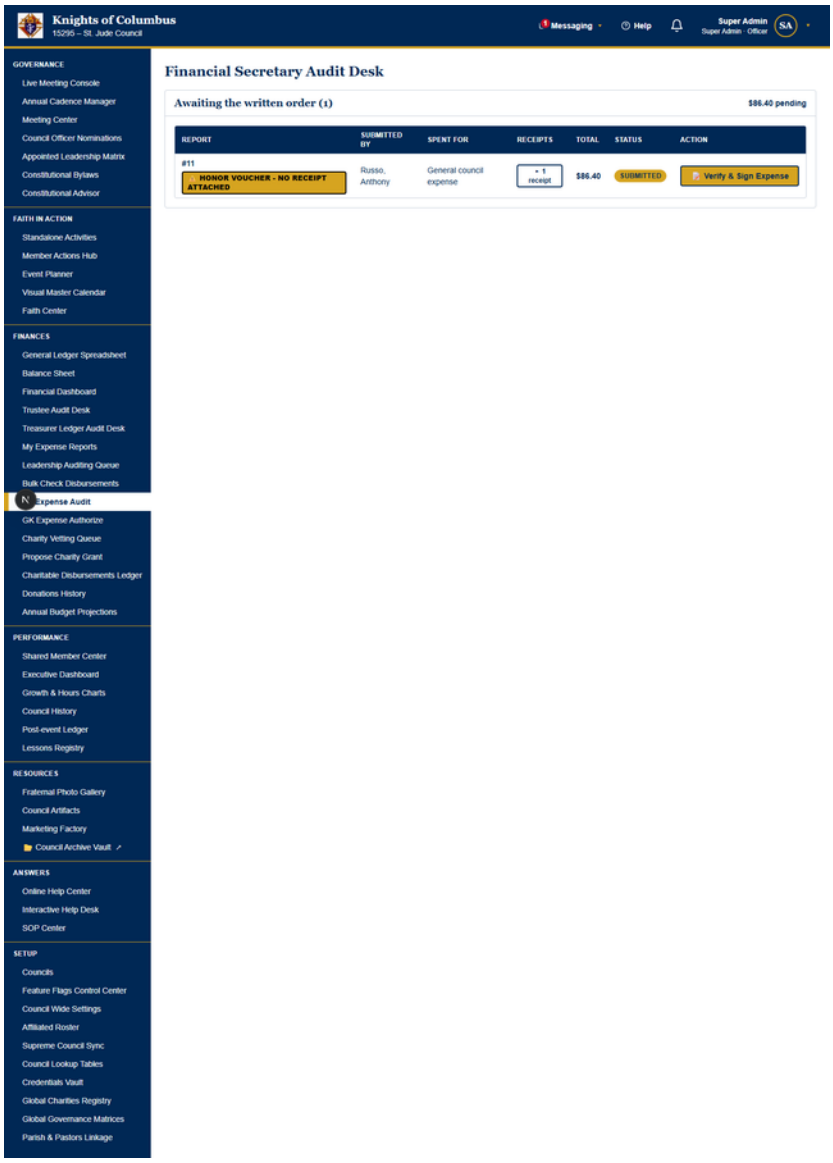
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary or a Super Admin. Council Admins read the desk only.
>
> **Warning:** the order is a signature. The report moves to the Grand Knight.

Goal: Approve a report's receipts as the first signature.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **FS Expense Audit**.

Steps:

1. Open the submitted report.
2. Check each receipt against its line.
3. Check the line in **Assign Ledger Budget Line Item**. A meeting report starts on the fraternal activities meetings line, for example **Monthly Council Meetings**.
4. Select **Verify & Sign Expense**.



FS Audit Desk (/expenses/audit)

Expected result: The report leaves the desk. The member sees **RECORDED BY FS**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
No ✍ **Verify & Sign Expense** button shows.	You submitted the report, or you do not hold the seat.	Another signer must act.
✍ **Verify & Sign Expense** is not available.	No budget line is chosen.	Choose a line in **Assign Ledger Budget Line Item**.

1.3 Return a report to the member

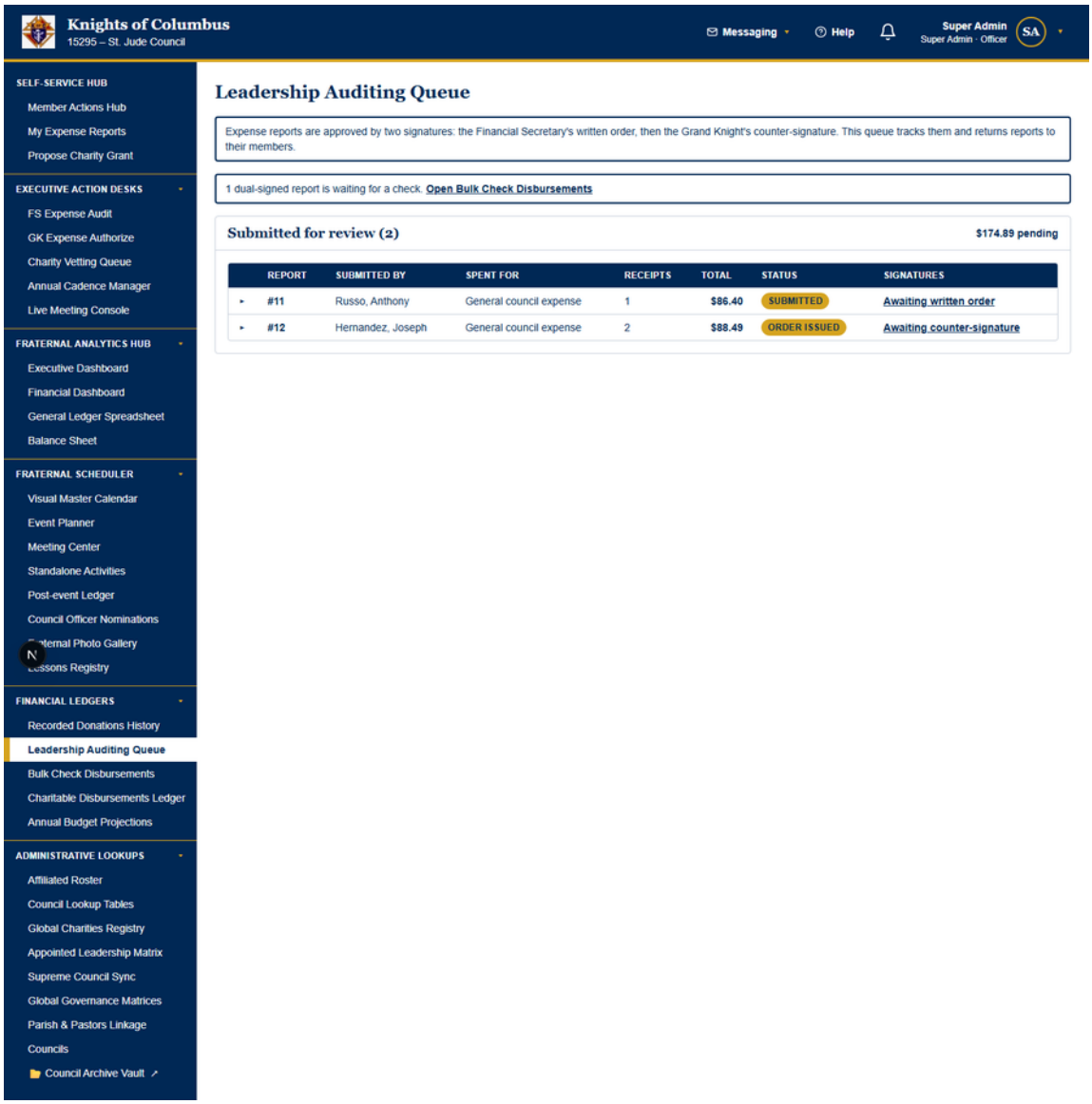
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning:** a return clears both signatures.

Goal: Send a report back for correction.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Financial Secretary Desk** → **Open the auditing queue**. The queue is not in the sidebar.

Steps:

1. Find the report.
2. Select **Reject & Return**.
3. Write the reason. The member reads the reason.
4. Confirm.



Leadership Auditing Queue (/expenses/queue)

Expected result: The member sees a red **Returned** tag with the reason.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The reason is too vague.	The member cannot fix the report.	Name the receipt and the change.

1.4 Pay approved reports by check

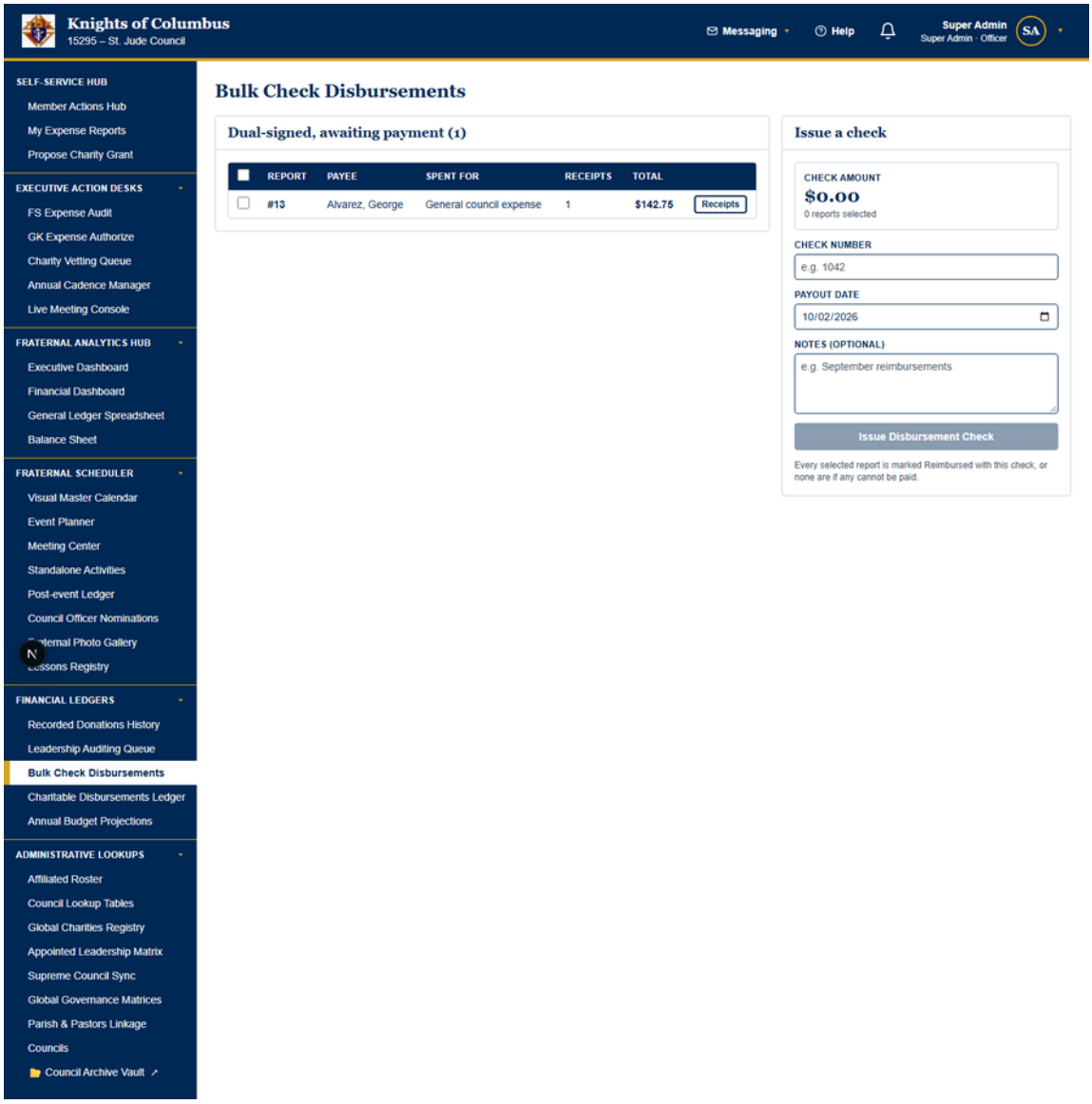
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary or Treasurer, or a Super Admin. An Admin without a finance role does not see the page.
>
> **Warning:** a recorded check is permanent money out of the council's books.

Goal: Record the checks for dual-signed reports.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Bulk Check Payments Made**.

Steps:

1. Tick the reports to pay. The page lists only reports with both signatures.
2. Enter the check number and the payout date for each report.
3. Save.



Bulk Check Payments Made (/expenses/disbursements)

Expected result: The member sees **Reimbursed** with the check number.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A report is missing.	The report lacks a signature.	Follow the report in the auditing queue (section 1.3).

1.5 Concept: the general ledger

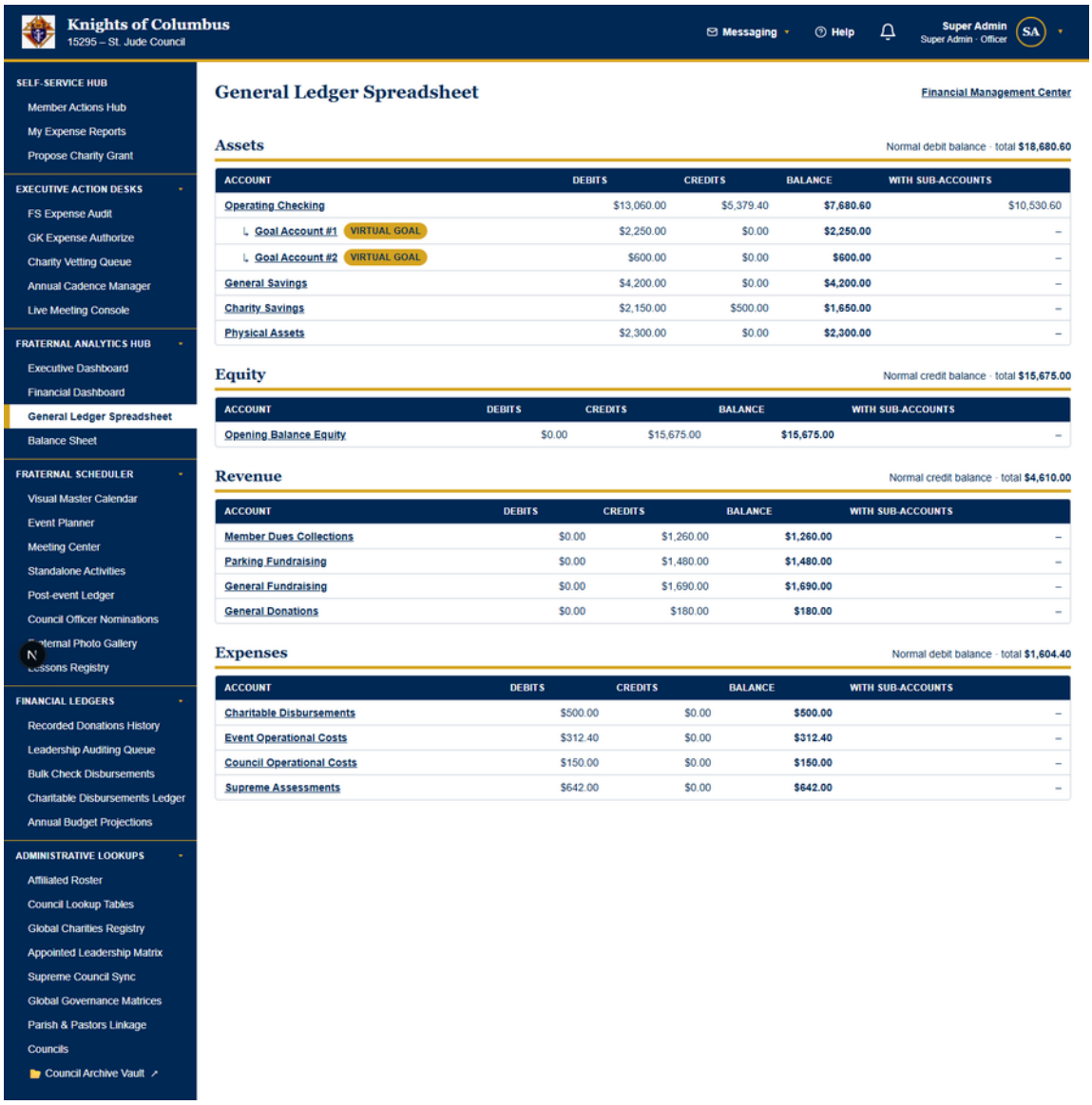
The general ledger is a double-entry ledger. Every transaction has debit lines and credit lines that balance. A shared transaction id groups the lines.

Page	Shows
General Ledger Spreadsheet	The chart of accounts with every posting
Balance Sheet	Assets against liabilities and equity
Financial Dashboard	Cash flow liquidity, the balance sheet summary and **Quick actions** (the transfer between accounts)

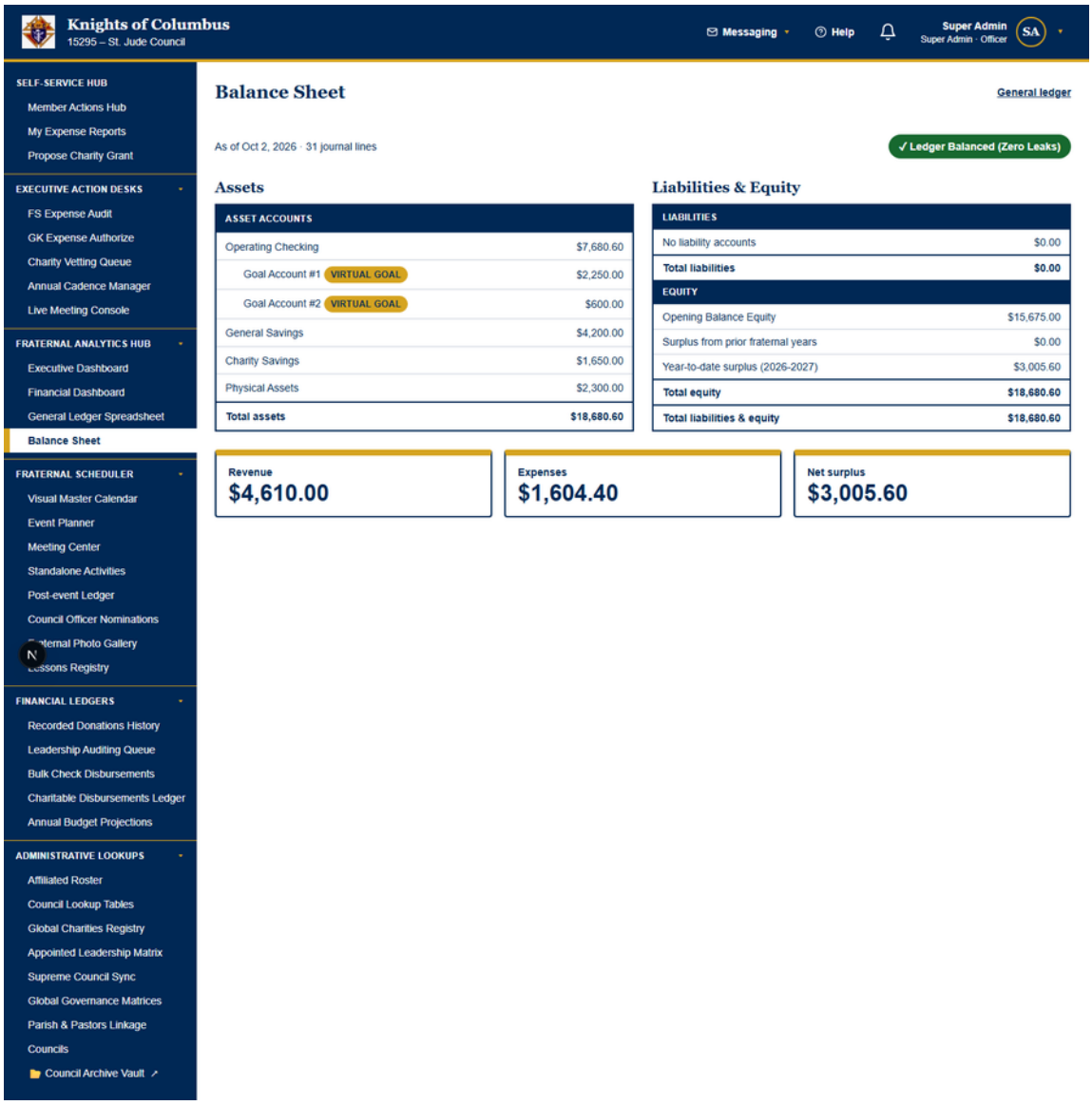
Seated officers and Admins read the three pages. Only the FS, the Treasurer and Super Admins post, transfer or upload bank statements.



Financial Dashboard (/finance/dashboard)



General Ledger Spreadsheet (/finance/ledger)



Balance Sheet (/finance/balance-sheet)

1.6 Post to the ledger or reconcile a bank statement

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary or Treasurer, or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning:** a posting changes the council's books for every reader.

Goal: Record a transaction, move funds or match a bank statement.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Financial Dashboard** → **Quick actions**.

Steps:

1. To post: choose the debit account and the credit account. Enter the amount and the description. Save.
2. To transfer: choose two asset accounts. Enter the amount. Save.
3. To reconcile: open **Active Desks** → **Treasurer Desk** → **Bank Statement Match-Window**. Upload the bank CSV file. The Financial Dashboard has no bank statement table.
4. Read the matched rows and the unmatched rows.

Expected result: The dashboard shows ✓ **Ledger Balanced (Zero Leaks)** when debits equal credits.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The transfer is refused.	The amount exceeds the source account balance.	Lower the amount.
The CSV file is refused.	The file has no Date column, or no Amount or Withdrawal/Deposit columns.	Export the statement again with a header row.
A bank row stays unmatched.	No posting has the same check number, or the same amount within 5 days.	Post the missing transaction. Upload again.

1.7 Vet a charity request

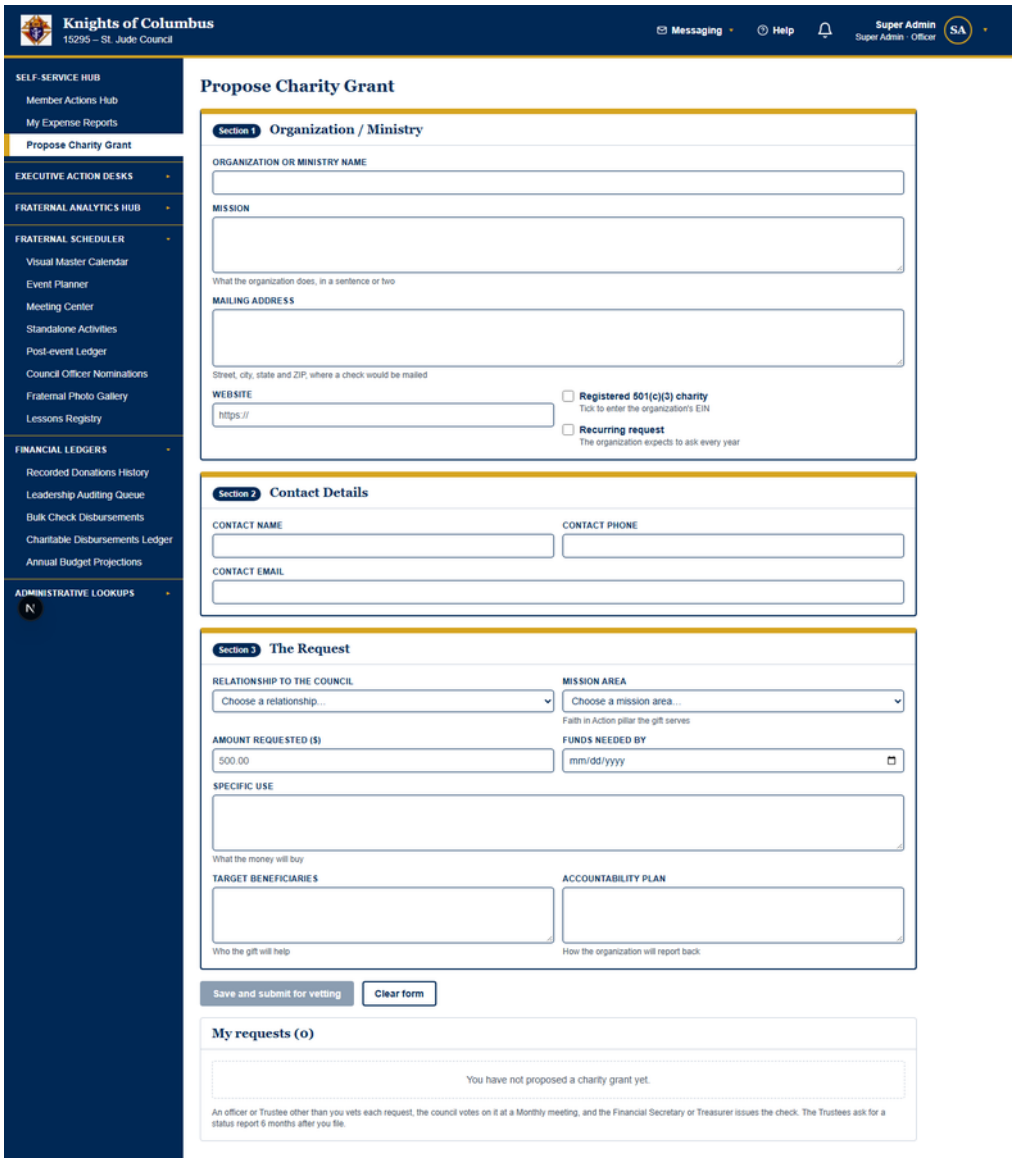
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a seated officer, a Trustee or an Admin of the council, or a Super Admin. The Knight Shepherd never vets the Shepherd's own request.
>
> **Warning:** a decline stops the request.

Goal: Review a member's charity request and move the request forward.

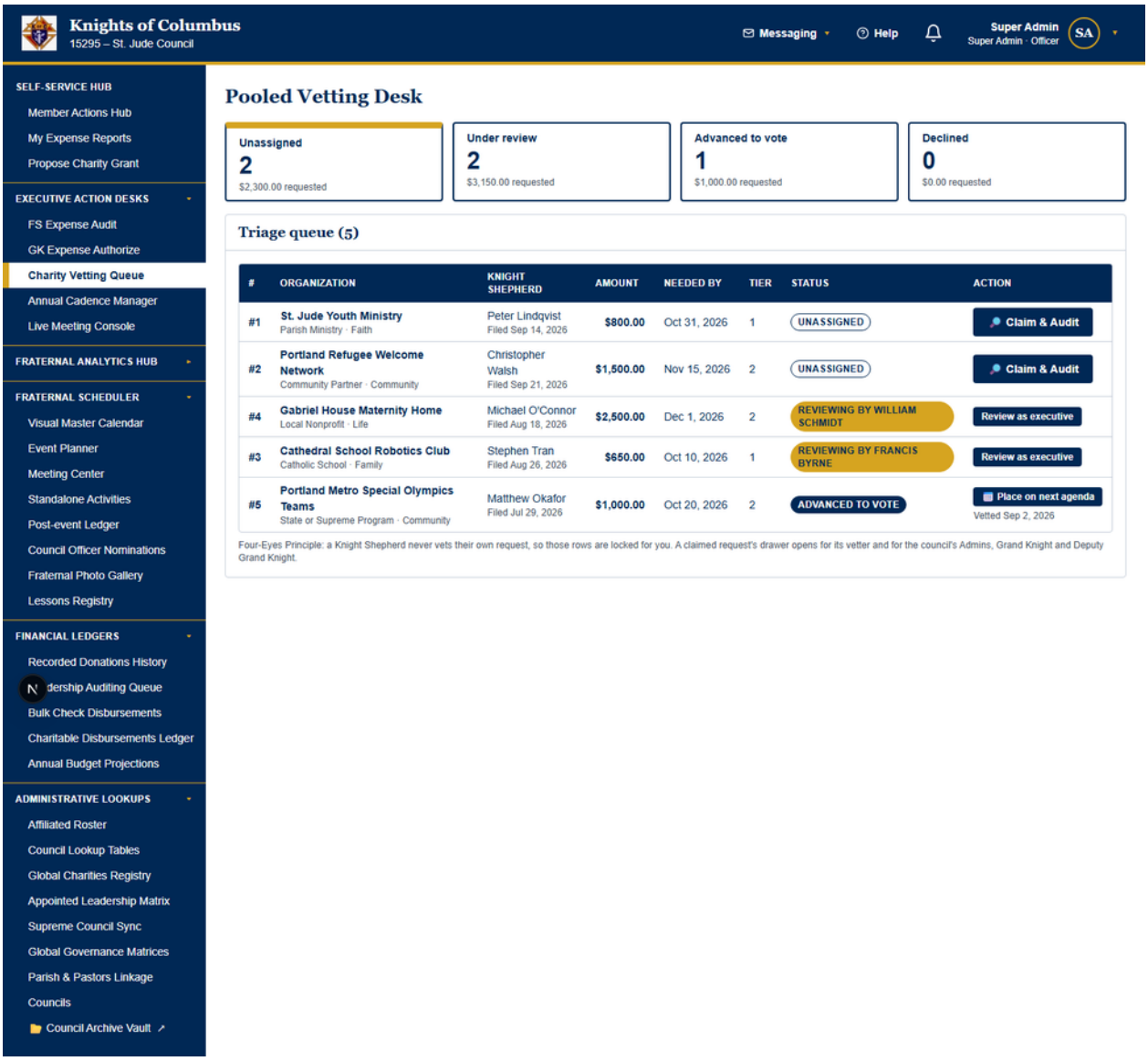
Start point: Active Desks → Grand Knight Desk → Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board folder. Other vetting officers use Sidebar → Finances → **Charity Vetting Queue**.

Steps:

1. Claim the request.
2. Check the organization, the 501(c)(3) status and the amount.
3. Advance the request, or decline the request.
4. For an advanced request, select **Place on next agenda**.



Propose Charity Grant (/charities/propose)



Charity Vetting Queue (/charities/vetting)

Expected result: The request goes on a Monthly meeting at least 10 days away. The council votes in the **Live Meeting Console**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Place on next agenda is refused.	No Monthly meeting is at least 10 days away.	Schedule the meeting.
The desk is missing.	The council switched off **Charity proposals**.	Ask a Super Admin.

1.7.1 Endorse an approved charity grant for payment

> **Who can do this:** the council's Financial Secretary (FS), Grand Knight (GK) or Deputy Grand Knight (DGK), or a Super Admin. The Knight Shepherd of the request cannot endorse it.
>
> **Warning:** you cannot undo an endorsement. The officer who endorses a request cannot also write its check.

Goal: Clear a grant that the council approved for its check. This is the **[✍ FS/GK Compliance Endorsement]** step.

Start point: Active Desks → Financial Secretary Desk or **Grand Knight Desk → FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**.

Steps:

1. Select the **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements** folder. A red border means that an approved request waits for your endorsement. The folder then moves to the top of the spine.
2. Find the request under **[✍ FS/GK Compliance Endorsement]**.
3. Check the organization and the approved amount.
4. Select ✍ **Endorse for payment**. You cannot undo the endorsement.

Expected result: The request moves to **[⛪ Treasurer Check Settlement]**. The Treasurer sees it in the **Charity Check Issuance Console** with its endorsement date.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request shows "You shepherd this request".	You are the Knight Shepherd of the request.	Ask another FS, GK or DGK to endorse it.
The endorse button does not show.	You are not the FS, GK or DGK of this council.	Ask one of these officers to endorse it.
The request is not in the endorsement step.	The council has not passed the motion yet.	Wait for the vote (section 1.7).

1.8 Pay an approved charity grant

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary or Treasurer, or a Super Admin. You cannot pay a request that you endorsed or that you shepherd.
>
> **Warning:** the check is permanent money out of the council's books.

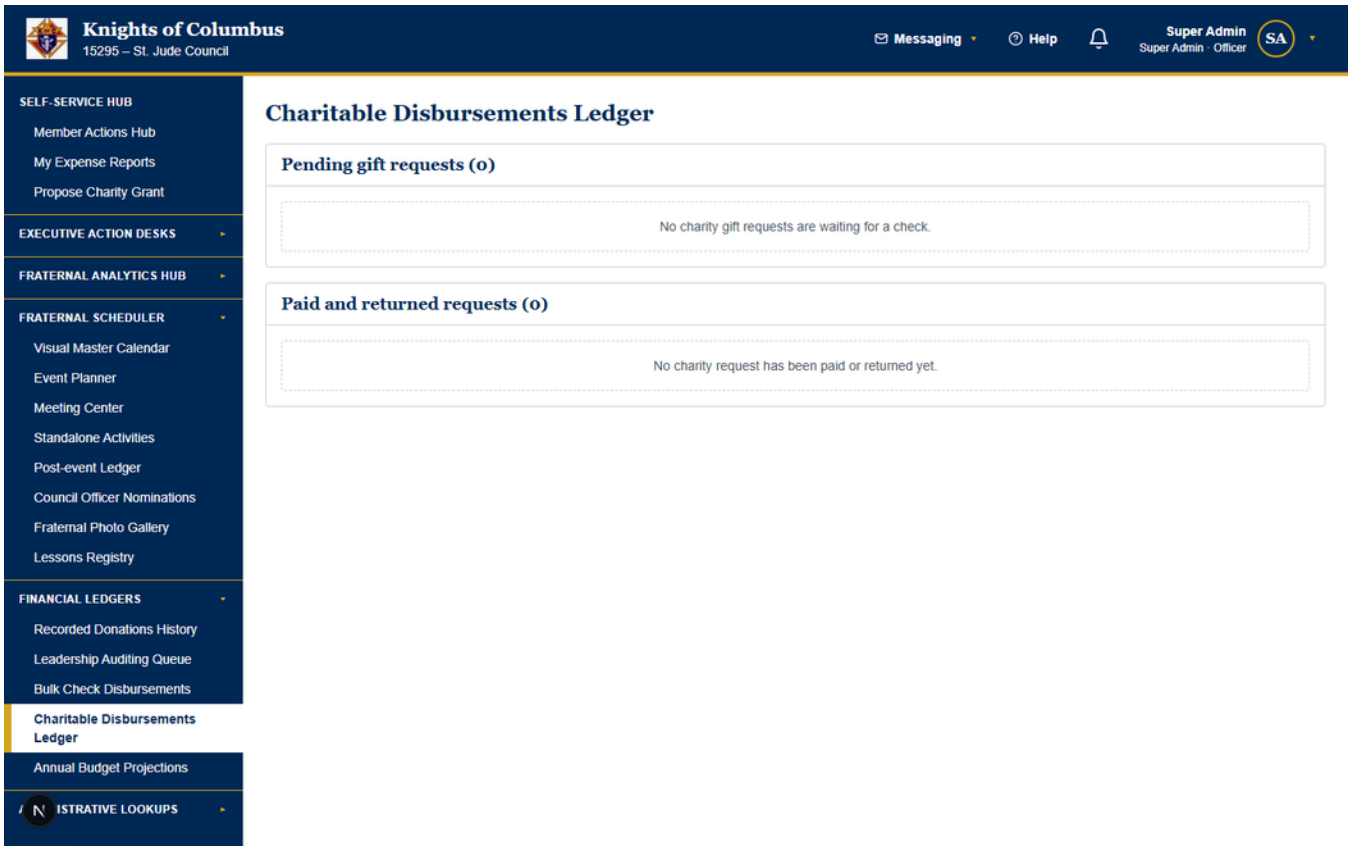
Goal: Pay a grant that the council approved and an FS or GK endorsed. This is the **[⛪ Treasurer Check Settlement]** step.

Start point: Active Desks → Treasurer Desk → Charitable Contribution Matches, or **Financial Secretary Desk → Charity Check Issuance Console**. The same console is on Sidebar → Finances → **Charity Payments Made Ledger**.

Steps:

1. Find the request in **Approved requests awaiting payment**. A request without its endorsement shows **Waiting for the FS/GK compliance endorsement** and has no pay button (section 1.7.1).
2. Click **Pay approved request**.
3. Type the **Check number**. Check the **Payout date**.
4. Choose the **Charity type (if not registered yet)**. The portal uses it only when the organization is not in the Global Charities Registry.
5. Optional: type **Notes (optional)**.
6. Click **Issue check for** the approved amount.

The check is always for the amount the council approved. The Knight Shepherd of the request cannot pay it.



Charity funding queue (/charities/queue)

Expected result: The request leaves **Approved requests awaiting payment**. The check is listed against the charity, the charity is added to the registry if it was not there, the request's target budget line is charged, and the Shepherd's **My requests** shows the request as paid.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request is missing.	The council has not passed the motion.	Check the motion in the meeting.
The request shows **Waiting for the FS/GK compliance endorsement**.	No FS, GK or DGK has endorsed it.	Ask one of them to endorse it (section 1.7.1).
The request shows "You endorsed this request".	The officer who endorses a request cannot pay it.	Ask another finance officer to write the check.
The check is refused with "already recorded check".	The council used that check number before.	Type the next unused check number.
The check is refused with "choose its charity type".	The organization is not in the registry yet.	Choose the **Charity type (if not registered yet)**.

1.9 Record or correct a donation

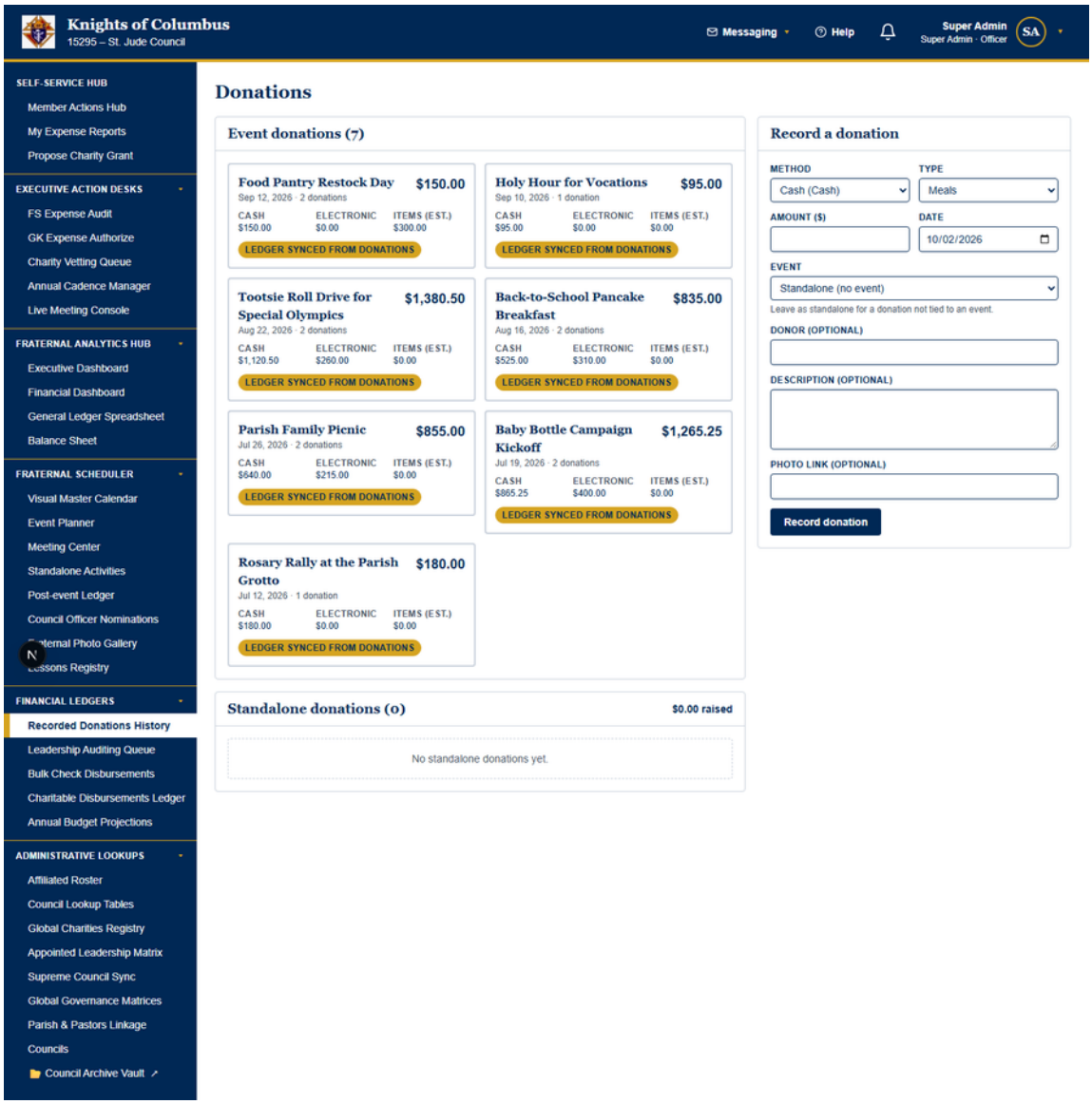
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary or a Super Admin. The recorder and the event owner may also correct a donation.

Goal: Keep the council's donation records complete.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Donations History**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Method**, the **Type** and the **Amount**. For items, enter **Estimated value ($)**.
2. Choose the **Date** and the **Event**, or *Standalone (no event)*.
3. Optional: add the **Donor**, a **Description** and a **Photo link**. Items need a description.
4. Save.



Donations History (/donations)

Expected result: The donation shows under **Event donations** or **Standalone donations**. An event card with cash or electronic donations shows ✓ **Automatically Logged to Treasury Ledger**.

To see the donations of one event, select its card. The card gets a thick gold border. The page scrolls down to the list of donations for that event.

Common problems:

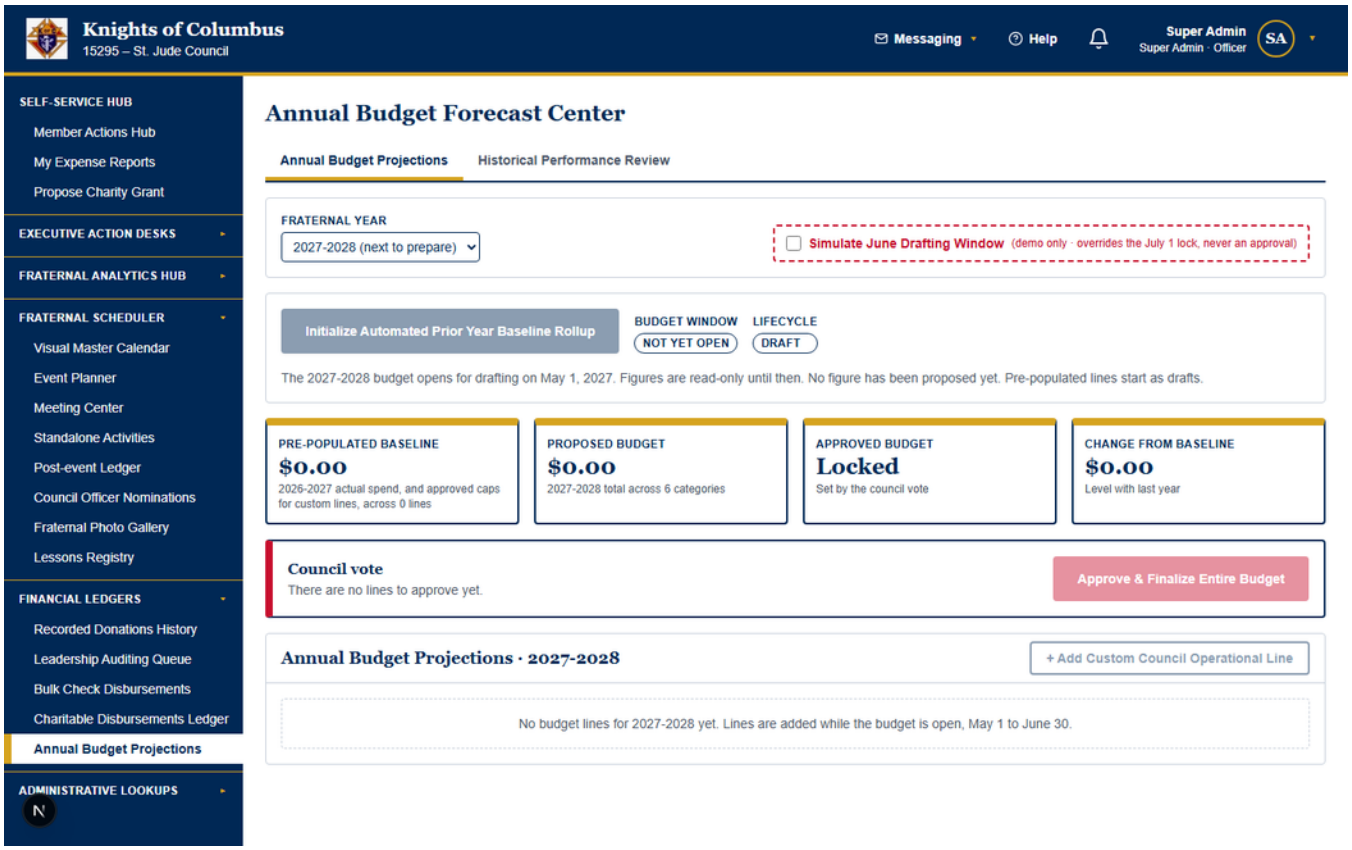
Problem	Cause	Fix
The date is refused.	An event donation is dated before the event start.	Use a date on or after the event start.
The council or the recorder cannot change.	The platform fixes both fields.	Delete the donation. Record the donation again.

1.10 Concept: the annual budget

The budget covers one fraternal year, July 1 to June 30.

Badge	When	What editors can do
Not Yet Open	Before May 1	Read only
Draft	May 1 (00:00) to June 30 (midnight)	Run the rollup, add lines, edit proposed amounts
Finalized	From July 1	Read only
Approved	After the council vote	Frozen for everyone

- Every member reads the budget. Non-editors see a **Transparency view** marked **Read only**.
- Editors are the council Admins, the Treasurer, the FS, the **Designated Budget Director** and Super Admins.
- A council Admin or a Super Admin assigns the **Designated Budget Director** in **Assign Designated Budget Director** at the top of the **Annual Budget Center**. Choose a member, or **Nobody**. The choice saves at once. The roster form has no Budget Director box.
- Only a Super Admin override changes a budget outside the window. No override reopens an approved budget.



Annual Budget Center (/budget)

1.11 Prepare the budget with the rollup

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary, the Designated Budget Director or a Super Admin. The year must be in **Draft**.

Goal: Fill the next year's budget from last year's actual spend.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Annual Budget Center**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Fraternal year**.
2. Select **Initialize Automated Prior Year Baseline Rollup**.
3. Type the proposed amount and **Notes** on each line. Each change saves when you leave the box.
4. Pick the **Category** of each line.
5. For a running cost, select **+ Add Custom Council Operational Line**. Enter the **Line item name** and the **Proposed budget amount**.

Expected result: Each line shows a **Pre-Populated Baseline**. The rollup reads three sources.

Source	Baseline
Each event tagged **Is Annual**	Last year's approved expenses linked to the event
Each charity tagged **Is Annual**	Last year's charity checks
Last year's custom lines	Last year's approved amount

A new rollup refreshes the baselines only. The rollup never changes proposed amounts, approved amounts or notes.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"The … budget opens for drafting on May 1"	The window has not opened.	Wait for May 1.
An annual event is missing.	The event has no **Is Annual** tag, or the event started outside last year.	Tick **Is Annual**. Run the rollup again.
"…already has a line named…"	The custom line exists.	Edit the existing line.

1.12 Approve and finalize the budget

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary or a Super Admin. The Designated Budget Director cannot approve.
>
> **Warning:** approval freezes the whole year for everyone. Nothing reopens an approved budget.

Goal: Record the council's vote on the budget.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Annual Budget Center**.

Steps:

1. Check every proposed amount.
2. Select **Approve & Finalize Entire Budget**.
3. Select **Yes, approve and finalize**. You cannot undo this step.

Expected result: Each proposed amount becomes the approved amount. The year shows **Approved**. The dashboard gauges use the approved amounts as caps.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The button is greyed out.	The year has no lines, or the year opens after May 1.	Run the rollup first.

1.13 Concept: receipts, split tickets and Honorary Expenses

A report holds one or more receipts. Each receipt has a merchant, a gross total and a receipt file. Each line item names the receipt it comes from.

Item	What it means	What the signers see
Receipt	One ticket from one merchant, with its full total and its file.	A **Receipts** table with **R1**, **R2** and so on.
Split ticket	One receipt with council items and personal items. The member lists all items and ticks **Personal** on the member's own items.	Personal lines are struck through. The total reads **Council reimburses**.
Honorary Expense	The member has no receipt. The member ticks ⚠ **I have no receipt (Honorary Expense)** and writes the reason.	⚠ **HONORARY EXPENSE - NO RECEIPT ATTACHED** with the member's reason.

- The council pays only the lines without **Personal**. Checks, budgets, asset costs and the balance sheet leave personal lines out.
- On a submitted report, the lines of each receipt must add up to the receipt's gross total.
- On a submitted report, each receipt needs its file. An Honorary Expense lifts this rule. The reason is mandatory.
- The ⚠ **HONORARY EXPENSE - NO RECEIPT ATTACHED** badge also shows on a report that has no receipt file at all.
- When receipt reading is connected (section 5.2 of the Administrator User Guide), 🔍 **Read receipt** fills in the merchant, the total and the lines from the attached photo. The member checks every figure before saving.

> **Warning:** check the reason on every Honorary Expense before you sign. The badge shows on the FS, Treasurer and GK desks and in the **Leadership Auditing Queue**.

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2. Members, setup codes, the Supreme roster sync and Supreme forms

2.1 Add a member

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.
>
> **Warning: Add Member** sends a welcome email with a setup code at once.

Goal: Put a new Brother Knight on the roster.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Roster**.

Steps:

1. Select **Add Member** at the top of the roster. The form opens in a drawer. A Super Admin first chooses the council in **Council**.
2. Fill in the form. **Email (also the login)** is the member's sign-in name.
3. Choose the **Member type**. Admins grant Admin or Member. Only a Super Admin grants Super Admin.
4. Select **Add member**.

The form has no **Designated Budget Director** box. An Admin assigns the Budget Director on the **Annual Budget Center** (section 1.10).



Member records (captured before the records moved to the Member Roster, /roster)

Expected result: A message confirms that a welcome email was queued. The member shows a NEW **New Member** badge for 180 days.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The new member cannot create a password.	The setup code expired after 14 days, or the email is wrong.	Check the email. Select **Send new setup code**.
You cannot move a member to another council.	Admins act on their own council only.	Ask a Super Admin.

2.2 Send a new setup code

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.
>
> **Warning:** a new code replaces the old code.

Goal: Help a member who lost or used up the setup code.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Roster** → **Edit** on the member's row.

Steps:

1. Select **Edit** on the member's row. The record opens in a drawer.
2. Select **Send new setup code**.

Expected result: The member gets a new welcome email. The new code is valid for 14 days.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The member already has a password.	A registered member does not need a code.	Tell the member to use **Forgot Password?**.

2.3 Concept: backend logic of the Supreme roster sync

The sync reads the roster export from Supreme Headquarters. The sync adds new members and updates join dates.

- The input is a CSV file with a header row. Save the Supreme Excel export as CSV first.
- The columns are Member Number, First Name, Last Name, Email, Phone, Street, Street 2, City, State, Zip, Birth Date, Degree, Date Joined and Charter Member.
- The Financial Secretary and Admins can download a ready Excel roster template with drop-down lists (3.3).
- Header case and spacing do not matter.
- The file must have the member number, the names, the email and the join date columns.

Row type	What the sync does
A new member number	Adds the member with the join date. Sends the welcome email with the Expo Go steps and a setup code.
A member number already on the roster	Updates the join date only. Other fields stay unchanged.
A row that fails a check	Skips the row. The result names the reason.

A setup code has 20 characters, expires after 14 days and works one time. The platform stores only a hash of the code. The platform has no background scheduler. The Financial Secretary or an Admin runs the sync by hand, from the **Financial Secretary Desk**.

2.4 Run the Supreme roster sync

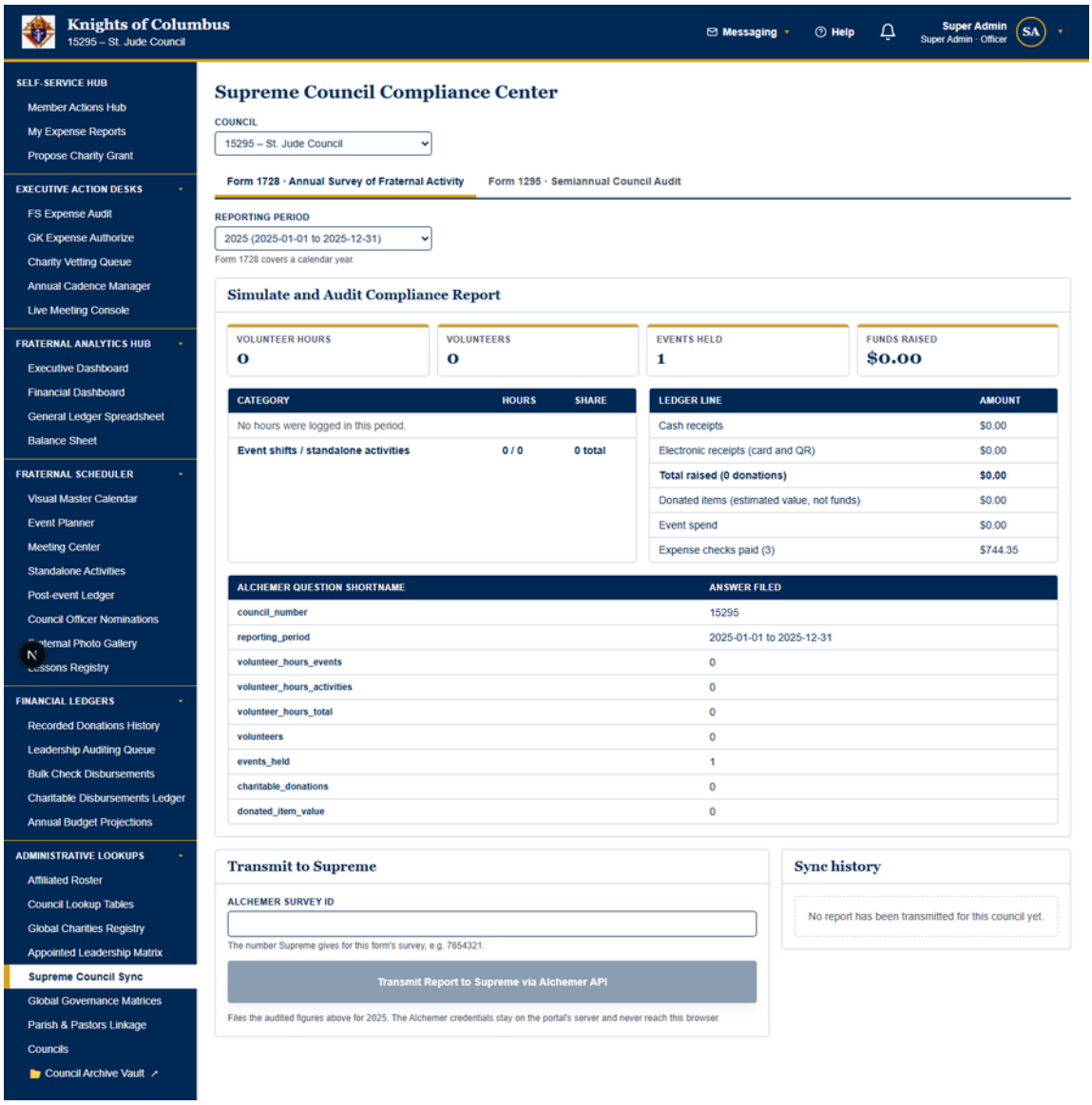
> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary, a council Admin or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning:** each new row sends a welcome email at once.

Goal: Bring the Supreme roster into the platform.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Financial Secretary Desk** → **Excel Roster Imports** → **Supreme roster CSV upload**.

Steps:

1. Save the Supreme Excel export as a CSV file.
2. Choose the file in **Roster file**.
3. Check the row count on the button.
4. Select **Sync *n* roster rows from Supreme**.
5. Read the skipped rows and the reasons.



Supreme sync (/supreme-sync)

Expected result: A message counts the new members, the updated join dates and the skipped rows. Each new member shows a 🆕 **New Member** badge.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The file is refused.	A required column is missing.	Add the missing column header.
A row is skipped.	The row has a bad email or a missing value.	Correct the row. Sync again.

2.5 File Form 1728 or Form 1295 with Supreme

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be a council Admin, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning: Transmit Report to Supreme via Alchemer API** sends the report to Supreme.

Goal: File a Supreme report from the council's records.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Supreme Council Sync**.

Steps:

1. Choose the **Supreme form**.
2. Choose a completed **Reporting period**. Form 1728 covers a calendar year. Form 1295 covers a half-year.
3. Check the figures in **Simulate and Audit Compliance Report**.
4. Enter the **Alchemer survey id**.
5. Select **Transmit Report to Supreme via Alchemer API**.

Expected result: The attempt shows in **Sync history**. A gold dot marks success. A red dot marks a failure with the reason.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The period is not offered.	The period has not ended.	Wait for the period end.
"The transmission failed and was logged"	Supreme refused the post.	Read the reason. Correct the figures. Transmit again.

3. The roster lifecycle

3.1 Concept: the council membership history

The platform keeps a history of every council that a member belongs to. The history does not change when a member moves.

Event	What the history records
A member is added or synced	A new membership in the council, from the join date when known
A Super Admin moves a member to another council	The old membership closes as **Former**. A new **Active** membership opens in the new council.
A status changes in the same council	The open membership shows the new status. **Deceased** or **Former** also closes the membership.

- A transferred member is always **Active** in the new council.
- A transfer takes the member off the old council's distribution lists.
- A transfer puts the member on the new council's council-wide distribution lists.
- A member marked **Deceased** or **Former** leaves every distribution list.
- A new member joins the council-wide distribution lists of the member's council.
- A member added before the history began shows the current council only, from the join date.

3.2 Read a member's council membership history

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the member's council, or Super Admin privileges. A member reads the member's own history on the **Council Dashboard**.

Goal: See every council a member belonged to.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Roster** → **Edit** on the member's row.

Steps:

1. Select **Edit** on the member's row.
2. Read the **Council membership history** card under the member form.

Expected result: The card lists each council, oldest first, with the status, the date joined and the date left. The current membership shows **current**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
You cannot move a member to another council.	Only a Super Admin moves members between councils.	Ask a Super Admin.
The join date shows **Not recorded**.	The member has no join date.	Enter the **Date joined council** on the member form.

3.3 Download the Excel roster template

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must be the council's Financial Secretary, a council Admin or a Super Admin.
>
> **Warning:** each new row sends a welcome email at once when you sync the roster.

Goal: Build a roster file by hand in Excel and load the file.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Financial Secretary Desk** → **Excel Roster Imports** → **Supreme roster CSV upload**.

Steps:

1. Select **Download the Excel roster template**.
2. Open the file in Excel. Row 2 is a sample. Replace the sample with a real member.
3. Fill one row for each member. Use the drop-down lists for **Role**, **Degree** and **Charter Member**.
4. Read the **Instructions** sheet for the rules of each column.
5. Save the **Roster** sheet as CSV (File → Save As → CSV UTF-8).
6. Load the CSV file in **Roster file**.
7. Select **Sync *n* roster rows from Supreme**. Each new member gets a welcome email at once.

Expected result: A message counts the new members, the updated join dates and the skipped rows.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A member's office is not set.	The sync does not assign offices from the **Role** column.	Fill offices through the elections and the Grand Knight's appointments.
Excel refuses a value.	The value is not on the drop-down list or is not a date.	Choose a value from the list. Enter dates as YYYY-MM-DD.
A **Charter Member** mark is missing.	The cell was not **Yes**.	Tick **Charter member** on the member form.

3.4 Check for inactive members (the inactivity sweep)

> **Prerequisite (who can do this):** You must have council Admin privileges for the council, or Super Admin privileges.
>
> **Warning:** the check changes the status of many members at once. The check has no undo button.

Goal: Mark members **Inactive** after more days without logged service than the council allows.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings** → **User Access & Roster Control** → **Roster Inactivity Sweep** card.

The **Roster Inactivity Sweep** card is the only place to run the check. The roster page and the **Financial Secretary Desk** do not show the button.

Steps:

1. Check the number of days in **Days without service before a member counts as inactive** (section 8.3 of the Administrator User Guide). The default is 365 days.
2. Scroll to the **Roster Inactivity Sweep** card.
3. Select 🔍 **Check for Inactive Members**. The check starts at once. You cannot undo the check.
4. Read the message. The message names each member marked **Inactive**.

Expected result: Each named member shows **Inactive** in the roster.

The sweep follows these rules:

- The sweep checks active members of the type **Member** only. The sweep never changes an Admin or a Super Admin.
- The sweep counts shift hours and activity hours. A member with no hours is measured from the join date.
- The sweep skips a member with no hours and no join date.
- The platform has no background scheduler. An Admin runs the check by hand.

- The council sets the number of days in **Days without service before a member counts as inactive**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A member was marked **Inactive** by mistake.	The member served but did not log hours.	Set the member's **Status** to **Active** on the member form. Ask the member to log hours.
A quiet member stays **Active**.	The member has no join date, or is an Admin.	Enter the **Date joined council**. Change an Admin's status by hand.
The card says *"Only the council's Admins and Super Admins run the sweep."*	Officers may open **Council Wide Settings**, but only Admins run the check.	Ask a council Admin to run the check.

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4. Payment methods, checks, asset photos and remote help

4.1 Concept: payment methods in the ledger

The ledger records how money came in. The **Payment method** list on the revenue card uses the same payment methods as the donation screens.

Payment method	Kind	Check number
Cash	Paper money	No
Credit Card	Card payment	No
Venmo	Electronic payment by QR code	No
Zelle	Electronic payment by QR code	No
Zeffy	Electronic payment by QR code	No
Parishsoft	Electronic payment by QR code	No
Check	Paper check	Yes, required

- The list shows only the methods that the council turned on. An Admin turns methods on in Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Lookup Tables**.
- **Physical Items** is never a payment method, because items are not money.
- An older ledger line, or a line that is not a payment, has no payment method.

A donation by check counts in the cash column of the event, because the council deposits checks with the cash. The donation records the check number too (section 4.1.1).

4.1.1 Concept: check numbers on donations

A donation by check now records the number printed on the check. The number helps the Financial Secretary match each check to the bank deposit.

- On the phone, the **Collect** tab shows a **Check** tile when the council turned Check on. The Check form has a **CHECK NUMBER (REQUIRED)** field.
- On the web, the **Donations History** form shows a **Check number** field when **Check** is the method.
- A donation by check cannot be saved without a check number. A donation by any other method cannot have a check number.

4.1.2 Record a donation by check on the phone

> **Who can do this:** Every member who takes donations.

Goal: Record a check donation with its check number.

Start point: Phone → **Collect** tab.

Steps:

1. Tap the **Check** tile.
2. Enter the amount in **AMOUNT**.
3. Enter the number printed on the check in **CHECK NUMBER (REQUIRED)**.
4. Choose the **DONATION TYPE**.
5. Enter the donor name, if the donor gives it.
6. Tap **Record donation**.

Expected result: A message says "Recorded" with the amount and "by Check". The donation shows in the list.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The message says "Enter the check number printed on the check."	The **CHECK NUMBER (REQUIRED)** field is empty.	Enter the check number, then tap **Record donation** again.
There is no **Check** tile.	The council did not turn Check on.	Ask an Admin to turn Check on in **Council Lookup Tables**.

4.2 Add a photo to a council asset

> **Who can do this:** The council's Grand Knight, Deputy Grand Knight, Trustees, Admins, Financial Secretary and Treasurer, or a Super Admin.

Goal: File a photo of the item in the council Google Drive and attach the photo to its asset record.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **My Expense Reports** → **Council assets** → **Edit** (or **Add photo**) on the asset row.

Steps:

1. Select **Upload photo** in the **Asset photo** box.
2. Choose an image file. The portal files the photo in Drive at once.
3. To change the photo, select **Replace photo** and choose another image.
4. To remove the photo from the asset, select **Remove photo**. The file stays in Drive.

Expected result: The photo shows on the asset form. The message says "Saved the photo of" and the asset name. The photo is in Drive under **Assets / <asset name>**. The inventory and the phone list show the photo.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The message says "The Drive vault is not configured." or "DRIVE_VAULT_LIVE is not on."	The council's Google Drive is not connected or not switched on.	Ask an Admin to connect Google Drive in **Credentials Vault**. Ask the portal host to switch the Drive vault on.
The message says the file "is not a file type the Assets folder takes."	The file is not an image.	Choose a photo file.
The message says "Google Drive did not accept the photo. Try again later."	Google Drive did not answer.	Wait a few minutes, then upload the photo again.
The form shows the details but no **Save asset details** button.	You are a Trustee.	Ask an asset manager to change the details. You can still add the photo.

4.3 Concept: co-watching remote assistance

An officer or Admin who needs help can share a copy of the screen with the Super Admins. The officer starts and stops the sharing. Nothing is shared until the officer selects **Share my screen**.

- The copy refreshes every 5 seconds while the officer shares.
- The copy never contains what the officer types in form fields. Passwords are never sent.
- The copy cannot run on the Super Admin's computer. The desk shows the copy as a still picture of the page.
- Sharing stops when the officer selects **Stop sharing**, when a Super Admin closes the request, or after 30 minutes without an update.

4.4 Ask for remote help

> **Who can do this:** Officers and Admins. Members and Super Admins do not see the button.

Goal: Let a Super Admin see your screen while you get help.

Start point: The portal header → **? Request Remote Officer Assistance**.

Steps:

1. Select **? Request Remote Officer Assistance**.
2. Enter what you need in **What do you need help with? (optional)**.
3. Select **Share my screen**.
4. Go to the page you need help with. The Super Admin sees each page you open.
5. Select **Stop sharing** when you finish.

Expected result: The header button turns red and says **● Sharing screen · Stop sharing**. After **Stop sharing**, the button goes back to **? Request Remote Officer Assistance**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request fails with a session message.	Your server session ended.	Sign out, then sign in again.
The red button changed back by itself.	A Super Admin closed the request, or 30 minutes passed.	Send a new request if you still need help.

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5. The Three-Signature Expense Flow

5.1 Concept: the Three-Signature Expense Flow

Under the roadmap, the **Three-Signature Expense Flow** draws the path of an expense report. Each box shows how many of the council's reports wait at that step.

Box	Who acts	What the step does
Member submits	Any member	The member submits the expense report.
1. Payment request	Financial Secretary	The Financial Secretary audits the report and issues the payment request.
2. Ledger coding	Treasurer	The Treasurer picks the budget line and the ledger account.
3. Counter-signature	Grand Knight	The Grand Knight signs. The report becomes Approved.
Check paid	Financial Secretary or Treasurer	The check is recorded. The report becomes Reimbursed.

- Council leadership may return a submitted report to the member as a draft, with a reason. The return clears the report's signatures.
- Nobody signs a report that they submitted. One officer never signs two lines of the same report.

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6. The Active Desks and the Financial Secretary Desk

6.1 Concept: the Active Desks row

The dashboard is a set of desks. A row of folder tabs sits under the navy header on every page. The row has the title **Active Desks**.

- Each tab looks like the tab of a paper file folder. A navy outline frames each tab.
- The open desk is white and raised. A deep gold edge runs along its top.
- **Home** is the first tab. **Member Desk** is the last tab.
- Select a tab on any page. The dashboard opens on that desk.
- Select the **Home** tab to return to **Home** from any page.
- Select **Executive Dashboard** in the sidebar to open the **Executive Summary** page. That page is not a desk tab. See section 14.11 of the Executive Governance Manual.

Every signed-in member sees the row. A plain member gets **Home** and **Member Desk**. Each officer seat adds its own desk.

A Council Historian without an officer seat and without Admin rights gets **Home**, **Historian Desk** and **Member Desk**. This Historian also gets the **Executive Dashboard** link in the sidebar (section 14.11 of the Executive Governance Manual).

After you sign in, the portal opens on the **Home** tab. This is true for every member, officer, Admin and Super Admin. When more cards are below the first screen, the line **Scroll down for more council info** ↓ shows at the bottom edge. The line fades away when you start to scroll down. The four tabs of the Volunteer Check-In & Service Center are on the **Member Actions Hub** (sidebar **Member Actions Hub**). They are not on the **Member Desk** tab.

Every module that a seat works in is a folder at the top of that seat's desk (section 6.2.1). You do not use the sidebar to find these modules. The **Leadership Auditing Queue** page opens from the **Financial Secretary Desk**.

6.2 Concept: the desks

A desk holds the work of one seat. Every officer desk is a desk blotter of drawers (section 6.2.2). You sign, code and pay inside a drawer on the desk. The **Member Desk** has no drawers.

The portal shows a desk tab only to a reader who may do the desk's work.

Tab	Who gets the tab	What the tab shows	Full desk page
Grand Knight Desk	The council's GK and DGK, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter: one drawer for each module (section 6.2.2), with **Approved Expenses** first. Under the drawers: the **Member Roster** panel.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Financial Secretary Desk	The council's FS, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter: one drawer for each module (section 6.2.2), with **Auditing & Return Queue** first. Under the drawers: the **Member Roster** panel.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Treasurer Desk	The council's Treasurer, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with **Ledger Line Coder**, **Expense Report (ER) Settlement** and **Charitable Contribution Matches** first.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Recorder Desk	The council's Recorder, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with the **Historical Meeting Minutes Archive** first on the spine.	None. You work inside the drawers.

Tab	Who gets the tab	What the tab shows	Full desk page
Historian Desk	The council's Council Historian, the council's Admins and Super Admins	The desk blotter, with the **Fraternal Diary Entry Logs** first.	None. You work inside the drawers.
Member Desk	Every reader of the dashboard	Top row, side by side: **[🚗 Open Shifts Needing Volunteers]** and **My shifts: next 30 days**. Under them: **[📥 My Charity Requests]** and **My open expense sheets**, then the **Member Roster** panel. No drawers.	Sidebar → Finances → **My Expense Reports**; Sidebar → Performance → **Council Dashboard**

6.2.1 Concept: the advanced modules on the desks

The desks no longer use module folders. Each advanced module below is a drawer on its desk (section 6.2.2). The module's own page also stays at its web address.

A drawer shows only to a reader who may open the module. A reader who may not open a module does not see its drawer.

Desk	Module drawer	What the module does
Grand Knight Desk	**Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board**	Claim, question, advance and place charity grant requests on the agenda (section 2 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Grand Knight Desk	**Constitutional Advisor Panels**	Ask a parliamentary or bylaws question. Officers only.
Grand Knight Desk	**Connected Councils**	Invite nearby councils and answer their invites (section 7).
Financial Secretary Desk	**Semiannual Audit Form 1295 Center**	The Trustees' step-by-step audit and the Form 1295 report.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charity Check Issuance Console**	Pay approved charity requests and gifts by check.
Treasurer Desk	**Annual Budget vs Actuals Ledger Grid**	**Budgeted vs. Current Actual Spend** and the 📊 **Budget Allocation & YOY Variance Analyzer**.
Treasurer Desk	**Bank Statement Match-Window**	Match a bank statement CSV file against the general ledger. Only the FS, the Treasurer and Super Admins can run the match.
Recorder Desk	**Council Resolutions and Motions Ledger**	Every motion on the council's meetings of this fraternal year, with its meeting, presenter, source and result.
Historian Desk	**Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board**	Upload and tag photos and build Smart Albums. Select a photo to open the viewer.

The Deputy Grand Knight (DGK) gets the same **Grand Knight Desk** drawers as the GK.

6.2.2 Concept: the filing spine, the Desk Blotter and the alert boundary

Every officer desk is a split-view console: the **Grand Knight Desk**, the **Financial Secretary Desk**, the **Treasurer Desk**, the **Recorder Desk** and the **Historian Desk**. The console has two parts:

- **The filing spine** (the left quarter of the desk). The spine is a flat list of folder links, one for each module. A folder shows the module name and, for a queue, the number of sheets that wait. No folder is inside another folder.
- **The Desk Blotter** (the right three quarters of the desk). The folder that you select opens here. The full module works on the blotter. You sign, verify and look up records on the blotter. You do not go to another page.

The spine has this order from the top:

1. **Priority: waiting on you.** Every folder with work that waits for you moves to the top of the spine, inside a red box. Each of these folders has a thick red border.
2. **The cabinets** (the **Financial Secretary Desk** and the **Treasurer Desk** only). Two cabinet blocks show, one above the other:

- **[📥 Inbound Operations]**: work that comes in to you. For example, payment requests, coding, cash box counts, donation records and bank matches.
- **[📤 Outbound Operations]**: money and reports that go out. For example, checks, charity matches, Church Disbursement Requests and the Form 1295.

3. **The other folders.** On the **Grand Knight Desk**, the **Recorder Desk** and the **Historian Desk**, the other folders show in one flat list.
4. **[🔧 Accounting Configuration]** (the **Treasurer Desk** only). This block holds the **Chart of Accounts & GL Setup** folder (section 6.4.1 of the Treasurer Manual).
5. **[📖 Reference Workflows]** (every officer desk). This block is always at the bottom of the spine. It holds the workflow drawers that you read for reference (section 6.2.3). A reference folder shows its count in grey. A reference folder never gets a red border and never moves to the top. The same sheet therefore lights only one folder: the folder where you sign.

To close a folder, select **[🔀 Back to Desk Blotter]** at the bottom of the blotter. You can also select **Close** or push **Esc**.

Alert boundary: a folder with a thick red border and a red glow has work that waits for you. It moves to the top of the spine. The folder also shows a red line that names the work, for example *"● Waiting for your signature"*. The desk checks the queues again every 30 seconds.

Desk	Folder with the alert boundary	The red border shows when
Grand Knight Desk	**Approved Expenses**	A sheet in the release queue waits for your final release, and you may sign it. A sheet that you submitted, ordered or coded does not light the border.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Auditing & Return Queue**	A sheet waits for its payment request, and you may sign it. Your own sheet does not light the border.
Grand Knight Desk	**Flagged Hours Review**	A time entry is held for review (section 10 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Grand Knight Desk	**Shifts Awaiting Hours**	A volunteer is past the first hours reminder and has not logged time.
Grand Knight Desk and **Financial Secretary Desk**	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	An approved charity grant waits for your endorsement, and you do not shepherd it.
Treasurer Desk	**Ledger Line Coder**	A signed sheet waits for your ledger account, and you may code it.
Treasurer Desk	**Expense Report (ER) Settlement**	A fully signed sheet waits for your check, and you may pay it. Your own sheet does not light the border.
Treasurer Desk	**Charitable Contribution Matches**	A charity request or gift waits for its check.
Recorder Desk	**Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**	The minutes of a meeting are due or overdue. The red line counts the overdue meetings.

The folders in **[📖 Reference Workflows]** never show the alert boundary. They are read only: they have no fields and no buttons. Open a reference folder to see the work that waits on each step. Do the work in the working folder that the step names. For example, the **Charitable Donation Workflow** folder counts the approved charity requests that wait for your endorsement. You endorse them in **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**.

The drawers on each desk:

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Grand Knight Desk	**Approved Expenses**	Select **Final Release for Payment** on each sheet.
Grand Knight Desk	**Flagged Hours Review**	Approve or reject the held time entries (section 10 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Grand Knight Desk	**Shifts Awaiting Hours**	Read the volunteers who served but have not logged time, with their phone numbers.
Grand Knight Desk	**Charitable Grant Requests Vetting Board**	Claim, question, advance and place charity grant requests on the agenda (section 2 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Grand Knight Desk	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	Select **Endorse for payment** on each approved charity grant (section 1.7.1).
Grand Knight Desk	**[Council Goals & Targets]**	Read the Star Council objectives of this fraternal year: Membership Intake, Charitable Dollars (funds raised) and Volunteer Hours, each against its target.
Grand Knight Desk	**Shared Loaner Library**	List, lend and check in council assets (section 15.3 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Grand Knight Desk	**Affiliation Invites**	Accept or decline invites from nearby councils.
Grand Knight Desk	**Connected Councils**	Invite nearby councils (section 7).
Grand Knight Desk	**Constitutional Advisor Panels**	Ask a parliamentary or bylaws question. For example, *How much notice does a motion need?* returns the Section 122(b) rule: 10 days' previous notice and a two-thirds vote.
Grand Knight Desk	**Operations Knowledge Archive**	Write a new entry (the GK, the DGK and Admins). Search the signed operating notes of every council (section 8).
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only.
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**Planning & Budgeting Workflow**	Read the planning steps, the goals and the budget status. Read only. Set and review the goals on **Council Wide Settings** (section 7).
Grand Knight Desk (reference)	**[Council Election Workflow]**	Read the four election steps, the progress wheels and the nominees. Read only. Nominate on the **Officer Nominations Desk** (section 6.2.3).
Financial Secretary Desk	**Auditing & Return Queue**	Select **Verify & Sign Expense** on each sheet, or return a sheet to its member with a reason. The sidebar link **FS Expense Audit** opens the same queue.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Expense Report (ER) Routing Track**	Read each open sheet and the signature that it waits for.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charitable Donation Records**	Record, check and correct council donations.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Church Disbursement Requests**	Record the check for the parish share (section 9).
Financial Secretary Desk	**FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**	Select **Endorse for payment** on each approved charity grant (section 1.7.1).
Financial Secretary Desk	**Charity Check Issuance Console**	Pay approved charity requests and gifts by check.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Semiannual Audit Form 1295 Center**	The Trustees' step-by-step audit and the Form 1295 report.
Financial Secretary Desk	**Excel Roster Imports**	Download the roster template. Upload the Supreme roster CSV.

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Financial Secretary Desk	**Operations Knowledge Archive**	Search the signed operating notes of every council (section 8).
Financial Secretary Desk (reference)	**Expense Report (ER) Workflow**	Read where each sheet waits. Read only. Sign in **Auditing & Return Queue** (section 6.2.3).
Financial Secretary Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only.
Treasurer Desk	**Ledger Line Coder**	Pick the ledger account. Read the green **Inferred Budget** line. Select 🏷 **Categorize & Lock Expense**. Log concluded revenue.
Treasurer Desk	**Expense Report (ER) Settlement**	Pay fully signed sheets by check.
Treasurer Desk	**Charitable Contribution Matches**	Match approved charity requests and gifts to their checks, and pay them.
Treasurer Desk	**Cash Box Audit Closure Panel**	Count each concluded event's cash box and log any variance (section 10 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk	**High-Volume Batch Transaction Coder**	Code many electronic donations to one Revenue line (section 10 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk	**Annual Budget vs Actuals Ledger Grid**	Read budgeted against actual spend and the variance analyzer.
Treasurer Desk	**Bank Statement Match-Window**	Match a bank statement CSV file against the general ledger.
Treasurer Desk	**Parish Fundraiser Revenue Split Console**	Issue the parish share of fundraiser revenue (section 9).
Treasurer Desk (accounting)	**Chart of Accounts & GL Setup**	Review every general ledger account, its type and its posted balance (section 6.4.1 of the Treasurer Manual).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Expense Report (ER) Workflow**	Read where each sheet waits. Read only. Code in **Ledger Line Coder** and pay in **Expense Report (ER) Settlement** (section 6.2.3).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Charitable Donation Workflow**	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. Read only. Pay in **Charitable Contribution Matches** (section 1.8).
Treasurer Desk (reference)	**Planning & Budgeting Workflow**	Read the planning steps and the budget status. Read only. Mark the budget reviewed on **Council Wide Settings** (section 7).
Recorder Desk	**Historical Meeting Minutes Archive**	Read the published minutes of every past meeting before you open a session (section 14.8.1 of the Executive Governance Manual). This drawer spans the top row of the desk.
Recorder Desk	**Meeting Minutes Entry Desk**	Write, save and publish the minutes (section 14.8 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Recorder Desk	**Start Live Meeting Sequence**	Start the live console and read the PIN (section 14.9 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Recorder Desk	**Council Resolutions and Motions Ledger**	Read every motion of this fraternal year and its result.
Recorder Desk (reference)	**[🥧 Council Election Workflow]**	Read the election steps and the progress wheels.
Historian Desk	**Fraternal Diary Entry Logs**	Read the council's diary entries by year, author or word (section 14.10.1 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Historian Desk	**Monthly Newsletters**	Write one newsletter a month (section 14.10 of the Executive Governance Manual).

Desk	Drawer	What you do in the drawer
Historian Desk	**Meeting Photos**	File each meeting's photo to Google Drive (section 14.10 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Historian Desk	**Oral History Recordings**	Listen to testimonials and record your own (section 14.10 of the Executive Governance Manual).
Historian Desk	**Google Drive Media Gallery Sync Board**	Upload and tag photos and build Smart Albums. A saved album opens at once as the active filter under **Smart Albums**. Select a photo to open the viewer. The Council Historian may tag photos to any past event or meeting of the council.
Historian Desk (reference)	**[🥧 Council Election Workflow]**	Read the election steps and the progress wheels.

A tile shows only to a reader who may open its module. An Admin who does not hold the seat reads the drawers but cannot sign.

Back to Desk Blotter: some work must open another page. For example, the release of a long-term asset opens the asset form. Then a **[🔀 Back to Desk Blotter]** bar shows under the tab row. Select the bar to go back to your desk.

The Oversight Desk is gone. Its audits are drawers on the **Grand Knight Desk**: **Flagged Hours Review** and **Shifts Awaiting Hours**. Council access requests are on the **Super Admin Desk** only (section 14.11 of the Executive Governance Manual). A saved `/dashboard#oversight` address opens your first tab.

A seat clears a desk only on the officer's own council. A Super Admin who picks another council in the council drop-down sees every desk of that council.

Earlier sections of this guide name the **Executive Dashboard** as a start point. For those tasks, select **Executive Dashboard** in the sidebar. The **Executive Summary** page opens.

Each tab has its own web address. The address is the dashboard address with the tab name after a # sign:

Tab	Address
Home	`/dashboard#home`
Grand Knight Desk	`/dashboard#grand-knight`
Financial Secretary Desk	`/dashboard#financial-secretary`
Treasurer Desk	`/dashboard#treasurer`
Recorder Desk	`/dashboard#recorder`
Historian Desk	`/dashboard#historian`
Member Desk	`/dashboard#member`

Save a desk address as a browser bookmark to open the desk directly. The browser also remembers the last tab you opened. The dashboard opens on that tab the next time. A tab you cannot open falls back to your first tab. For most readers, the first tab is **Home**.

6.2.3 Concept: the workflow drawers

Three drawers show a whole workflow in one place. Each workflow drawer uses the layout of the **Planning & Budgeting Workflow** drawer:

- A highlighted action bar at the top. One sentence tells you what happens now and names the working folder where you act. The bar stays gold: a reference folder never turns red.
- A row of numbered steps. The current step has a gold border and the label **(now)**. A done step has a tick.
- A step that you act on carries the tag **Your step**. A step with a queue shows the number of items waiting.

- Progress wheels. Each wheel fills as its count comes closer to complete.

Drawer	Desks	Steps	What you do in the drawer
Expense Report (ER) Workflow	**Financial Secretary Desk** and **Treasurer Desk** (in **[🕮 Reference Workflows]**)	1. **Payment request** (FS). 2. **Ledger coding** (Treasurer). 3. **GK approval** (Grand Knight). 4. **Check issued** (Treasurer).	Read **Every open sheet**: each sheet, its total, the step it waits at and who acts. The Financial Secretary signs in **Auditing & Return Queue**. The Treasurer codes in **Ledger Line Coder** and pays in **Expense Report (ER) Settlement**.
Charitable Donation Workflow	**Financial Secretary Desk**, **Treasurer Desk** and **Grand Knight Desk** (in **[🕮 Reference Workflows]**)	1. **[📋 Member Charity Request]** (Knight Shepherd, vetters, council vote). 2. **[✍ FS/GK Compliance Endorsement]** (FS, GK or DGK). 3. **[🏛 Treasurer Check Settlement]** (Treasurer).	Read where each outgoing charity grant waits. The FS, GK and DGK endorse in **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements**. The Treasurer pays in **Charitable Contribution Matches** (the FS in **Charity Check Issuance Console**). Gifts coming in stay on the batch coder and cash box drawers.
[🗳 Council Election Workflow]	**Grand Knight Desk**, **Recorder Desk** and **Historian Desk** (in **[🕮 Reference Workflows]**)	1. **Open the ballot** (before May 1). 2. **Nominations** (May 1 - 31). 3. **Election** (June). 4. **New term** (July 1).	Read the wheels **Offices on the ballot** and **Offices with a nominee**, and the nominees of each office. Nominate on the **Officer Nominations Desk** (Sidebar). Admins set the ballot on **Council Lookups**.

The workflow drawers have no fields and no buttons. They read the same records as the working folders, so a sheet signed in **Auditing & Return Queue**, **Ledger Line Coder** or **Expense Report (ER) Settlement** moves to its next step in the workflow drawer.

The workflow drawers are reference folders. They sit in the **[🕮 Reference Workflows]** block at the bottom of the spine. They never get the red border, so a waiting sheet lights only its signing folder.

The **[🗳 Council Election Workflow]** drawer replaces the **Council Election Tracker** drawer. A mid-year election leads the action bar while its nominations are open.

6.3 Open a drawer on your desk

> **Who can do this:** the seat holder of the desk, the council's Admins and Super Admins. A drawer shows only when your role may open its module.

Goal: Work in an advanced module without leaving your desk.

Start point: Active Desks row → your desk.

Steps:

1. Select your desk tab.
2. Find the tile of the module. A tile with a red border has work for you.
3. Select the tile. The drawer slides out from the right.
4. Do the work in the module.
5. Select **[🔀 Back to Desk Blotter]**.

Expected result: The module works inside the drawer the same as on its own page.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A drawer in section 6.2.2 is not on your desk.	Your role may not open that module, or the council switched the module off.	Ask the seat holder or a Super Admin.
The **Bank Statement Match-Window** shows a notice and no upload box.	Only the FS, the Treasurer and Super Admins can match bank statements.	Ask the Treasurer to run the match.
You want the module on a larger screen.	The drawer is narrower than the full page.	Open the module's page from the sidebar.

6.4 Work the Financial Secretary Desk and the roster imports

> **Who can do this:** the council's Financial Secretary and Super Admins sign orders. Only the council's Admins and Super Admins import the roster.
>
> **Warning:** the roster import sends a welcome email to each new member. You cannot recall an email.

Goal: Sign the waiting expense orders without leaving the desk, and keep the roster current.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Financial Secretary Desk**.

Steps:

1. Select the **Financial Secretary Desk** tab.
2. Find the **Auditing & Return Queue** folder. A red glowing border means that a sheet waits for your signature.
3. Select the **Auditing & Return Queue** folder. The queue opens on the Desk Blotter.
4. Select 📝 **Verify & Sign Expense** on each sheet. To send a sheet back, type the reason and select **Return to member**.
5. Select **[🔀 Back to Desk Blotter]**.
6. To follow a sheet, select the **Expense Report (ER) Workflow** folder under **[🕮 Reference Workflows]**, or the **Expense Report (ER) Routing Track** folder. To record a donation, select the **Charitable Donation Records** tile. To endorse an approved charity grant, select the **FS/GK Compliance Endorsements** folder (section 1.7.1).
7. Select the **Excel Roster Imports** tile. Select **Download the Excel roster template**.
8. Fill in the template. Save the **Roster** sheet as CSV.
9. In the same drawer, choose the CSV file in **Roster file**. Select **Sync *n* roster rows from Supreme**. Each new member gets a welcome email.

Expected result: The signed sheets move to the Treasurer. The count on the **Auditing & Return Queue** folder drops when you close the folder. The new members show in the roster.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The inactivity sweep is not on the desk.	The sweep moved to System Settings.	Open Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings** (section 3.4).
The roster file does not load.	The file is not CSV.	Save the **Roster** sheet as CSV, then load the file again.

7. The budget review and vote

7.1 Concept: the Annual Budget Planner

The council plans each fraternal year in the two months before the year starts. The fraternal year runs from July 1 to June 30.

Step	When	What happens
Draft	May 1 - May 31	Leadership drafts the Annual Council Goals and the budget lines.
Review	June 1 - June 30	Leadership checks the goals and the budget. Leadership marks each one reviewed.
Lock	July 1	The year starts. The goals become read-only for good. The budget figures lock.
Final vote	By July 10	The council votes the budget. The vote locks every budget line.

The goals and the budget each show one status:

Status	Meaning
Draft	Nobody marked the goals or the budget reviewed yet.
Reviewed	Leadership marked the goals or the budget reviewed. Leadership can still change the goals until July 1.
Locked	The year started (goals), or the council voted (budget).

The July 1 goals lock has no exception. Nobody can change the goals of a started year, not even a Super Admin. Set the goals before July 1.

The budget vote must be recorded by July 10. After July 10, only a Super Admin can record the vote, with the override.

The **Annual Budget Planner** banner leads the **Council Wide Settings** page. The banner shows the four steps and marks the current step **(now)**. Under the steps, the banner shows the year's goals and the budget status.

7.2 Mark the budget reviewed

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer, the Designated Budget Director and Super Admins.

Goal: Record that leadership reviewed the drafted budget in June.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Annual Budget Center** → **Annual Budget Planner** → **Annual budget**.

Steps:

1. Choose the year in **Fraternal year**.
2. Select **Open the budget** to read the budget lines.
3. Go back to **Council Wide Settings**.
4. Select **Mark budget reviewed**.

Expected result: The budget shows the **Reviewed** status.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Mark budget reviewed does not show.	The drafting window is closed, the budget has no lines, or the budget is already reviewed.	Mark the budget reviewed between May 1 and June 30.

7.3 Record the council's budget vote by July 10

> **Who can do this:** the council's Admins, the Financial Secretary, the Treasurer and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning:** the vote locks every budget line. You cannot undo the vote.

Goal: Record the council's vote on the budget at the July meeting.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Annual Budget Center**.

Steps:

1. Choose the fraternal year.
2. Select **Approve & Finalize Entire Budget**.
3. Confirm the approval. You cannot undo this.

Expected result: The budget shows **Approved**. The planning banner shows the budget as **Locked**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The portal says the vote deadline passed.	Today is after July 10.	Ask a Super Admin to record the vote with the override.

8. The Operations Knowledge Archive

8.1 Search the Operations Knowledge Archive

> **Who can do this:** the officers and Admins of every council, and Super Admins. Other members do not see this page.

Goal: Find the notes past leaders of your council, or of brother councils, saved about one subject or one year.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Operations Knowledge Archive**. The address is `/system-settings/knowledge-archive`. The **Open the archive** link on the vault card opens the same page.

Steps:

1. Select **Filter by My Home Council Only** to see only your council's entries. Clear the box to see every council.
2. Select a tag in **Governance tag**. Select **Every tag** to see all tags.
3. Select a year in **Fraternal year**. A fraternal year runs from July 1 to June 30.
4. Type words in **Search** to find a note, a signature or a council name.
5. Select a row to read the full note. Select the row again to close the note.

Expected result: The grid shows the matching entries, newest first. Each row shows the date, the fraternal year, the council badge, the tag and the signature.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The grid says **No entry matches these filters.**	No entry has all the selected filters.	Select **Every tag** or **Every year**, or clear **Search**.
Entries from other councils show.	The archive shows every council.	Select **Filter by My Home Council Only**.
Your council's entries do not show.	The search words or filters exclude them.	Clear **Search**, and select **Every tag** and **Every year**.
You cannot add an entry here.	This page is read-only.	Write entries in the **Operations Knowledge Archive** drawer of the **Grand Knight Desk** (section 17.2 of the Executive Governance Manual).

9. Parish fundraiser splits and Church Disbursement Requests

9.1 Concept: the parish fundraiser split

Some fundraisers use parish property, for example the cathedral parking lot. The council then owes the parish a share of the money collected. The parish split calculates that share and pays it by check.

Each council sets its own split on **Council Wide Settings → Feature Controls → Parish Fundraiser Split**:

Setting	What it does	Default
The parish split is on / off	Switches the split on or off.	Off
Parish share (%)	The parish's percentage of each event's collections, from 0.01 to 100.	50
General ledger line for the parish share	The ledger line that the payment to the parish is charged to. The line is a revenue line or an expense line.	None

The split cannot be on without a ledger line. When the switch is on and no line is chosen, the card shows a red message and **Save parish split** stays unavailable.

A revenue line takes the parish share back out of the fundraiser's revenue. The St. Mary's pilot data has the revenue line **Parish Fundraiser Share** for this purpose.

9.2 Concept: the Church Disbursement Request

The split moves in two signatures:

Step	Who	Where	What happens
1	Treasurer	**Treasurer Desk → Parish Fundraiser Revenue Split Console**	The Treasurer issues a **Church Disbursement Request** for the parish share. The request is **Pending**. The ledger does not change yet.
2	Financial Secretary (FS)	**Financial Secretary Desk → Church Disbursement Requests**	The FS enters the check number and records the payment. The request is **Paid**.

The console counts each event's money donations. Physical items do not count. The **To request** amount is the parish share less the shares already requested for the event. New collections at a later date make a new amount available.

When the FS records the payment, the ledger gets one posting. The posting is a debit to the split's ledger line and a credit to the council's first cash account. Both lines carry the check number.

The officer who issues a request cannot also pay the request.

9.3 Set up the parish split

> **Who can do this:** the council's officers, the council's Admins and Super Admins.

Goal: Switch the parish split on with a percentage and a ledger line.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Wide Settings → Feature Controls → Parish Fundraiser Split**. The Treasurer can also select **Switch it on in Council Wide Settings** on the console.

Steps:

1. Select the switch. The switch shows **The parish split is on**.
2. Enter the percentage in **Parish share (%)**, for example `50`.
3. Select the line in **General ledger line for the parish share**.
4. Select **Save parish split**.

Expected result: The message **Saved for council … The split is on.** shows. The Treasurer's console names the line and the percentage.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A red message shows and **Save parish split** is unavailable.	The split is on, but no ledger line is chosen.	Select a line in **General ledger line for the parish share**.
The line you want is not in the list.	Only revenue lines and expense lines of your council show.	Ask the Treasurer to add the line to the chart of accounts.

9.4 Pay a Church Disbursement Request

> **Who can do this:** the council's Financial Secretary and Super Admins. The officer who issued the request cannot pay the request.
>
> **Warning:** Recording the payment posts money to the general ledger. You cannot undo the payment.

Goal: Record the check that pays the parish share.

Start point: Active Desks row → **Financial Secretary Desk** → ⛪ **Church Disbursement Requests**.

Steps:

1. Find the request. Check the event, the amount, the ledger line and the issuer.
2. Write the check to the parish.
3. Enter the check number in **Check number**.
4. Select **Record Payment Made**. You cannot undo the payment.

Expected result: The message **Check … for $… is recorded against …** shows. The request leaves the card. The Treasurer's console shows **Paid · check …**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Record Payment Made is unavailable.	The check number is empty, or you issued the request.	Enter the check number, or ask another finance officer to pay.

10. Payment account ownership

10.1 Concept: who owns a payment account

Each payment method that a council turns on pays into one account. A card reader, a Venmo page, a Zelle profile and a parish giving portal are examples. The **Account owner** column on **Enabled donation methods** records who owns that account.

Account owner	Meaning
Council account	The money lands in the council's own account. The council's books record the money as revenue.
Parish account	The money lands in the parish's account. The parish already holds the money.
Third-party account	The money lands in the account of a vendor or a partner charity.

The portal does not guess the owner. A new payment method starts with no owner. The editor does not save until you choose one. Methods that were set up before Sprint 8O read as **Council account**.

Each donation keeps the owner that its payment method had at the moment the donation was recorded. A later change to the owner does not change past donations. The change applies only to donations recorded after the change. Past parish splits and batch coding therefore stay the same when you correct a payment method. An edit that moves a donation to a different payment method takes that method's owner at the moment of the edit.

10.2 Set the account owner of a payment method

> **Who can do this:** council Admins, the council's Financial Secretary and Treasurer, and Super Admins.

Goal: Record who owns the account that each payment method pays into.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Lookups** → **Enabled donation methods**.

Steps:

1. Find the payment method. To add a method, select **Add donation method**.
2. In **Account owner**, select **Council account**, **Parish account** or **Third-party account**.
3. Select **Save changes**.

Expected result: The message **Saved … donation method rows.** shows. The owner shows on the row.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Save changes is unavailable and a red message says *"Choose who owns the account each payment method pays into (Council, Parish or Third party) before you save."*	A changed row shows **Choose…** in **Account owner**.	Choose the owner on each row with a red border.
A parish fundraiser shows no parish-held revenue.	The parish's giving method was set to **Council account** when the donations were recorded.	Set the method to **Parish account** before the next event. Past donations keep their recorded owner.
You changed the owner, but past events did not change.	Each donation keeps the owner it was recorded under.	No fix is needed. Only new donations use the new owner.

11. Budget categories and payment account names

11.1 Concept: the council's budget categories

The council keeps its own list of budget categories, for example **Youth Programs** or **Charities**. Each budget line can be filed under one category. A line without a category shows under **Uncategorized**.

The **Budget Allocation & YOY Variance Analyzer** groups the year by these categories in two charts:

Chart	What the chart shows
Allocation Pie	Each category's share of the year's budget. Before the vote, the pie uses the proposed figures. After the vote, it uses the approved figures.
Year-to-date spending against each cap	Each category's spending since July 1 against its approved cap. **✕ Over** marks a category over its cap.

A table under the charts lists each category with its figures. The first eight categories keep their colors. More categories show together as **Other**.

11.2 Keep the budget categories

> **Who can do this:** the council's Financial Secretary (FS), Treasurer and Admins, and Super Admins.
>
> **Warning: Delete** removes the category at once. The portal refuses to delete a category that a budget line still uses.

Goal: Add, rename or delete the council's budget categories.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Budget** → **Budget categories** panel.

Steps:

1. To add a category, enter the name in **New category**. Select **Add category**.
2. To rename a category, change its name. Select **Rename**.
3. To delete a category, select **Delete**. You cannot undo this.
4. In **Annual Budget Center**, choose the category on each line.

Expected result: A message confirms the change. The category list and the line pickers show the change.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The panel does not show.	You are not the FS, the Treasurer or an Admin.	Ask the FS or the Treasurer.
A category cannot be deleted.	A budget line still uses the category.	Choose another category on those lines first.
The charts do not show on the analyzer.	You may not read the budget progress.	Ask the Grand Knight or the Treasurer.

11.3 Name the account behind a payment method

> **Who can do this:** council Admins, the council's Financial Secretary and Treasurer, and Super Admins.

Goal: Show donors whose account a QR code pays into.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Council Lookups** → **Enabled donation methods**.

Steps:

1. Find the payment method, for example **Venmo**.

2. Check the **Account owner** (10.2).
3. In **Account name donors see**, enter the account name as the payment app shows it, for example `St. Mary's Cathedral Parish`.
4. Select **Save changes**.

Expected result: On the phone, the QR code screen shows *"Pays into St. Mary's Cathedral Parish (Parish account)"* under the heading.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The phone shows *"Pays into the council's account"* only.	The method has no account name.	Enter the account name (step 3).
The phone shows the wrong owner.	The **Account owner** is wrong.	Correct the owner (10.2).

Manual map

The chapters of the four officer manuals. A shared task is printed in each manual that lists its chapter.

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- 3. The Google Drive archive vault
- 4. The feedback inbox and SOP publishing
- 5. Lookup tables, service connections and global lists
- 6. Data protection rules
- 7. Troubleshooting reference
- 8. Council Wide Settings and platform settings
- 9. Access requests, impersonation and remote help
- 10. Feedback loops and the Super Admin Desk
- 11. Run a room pilot on the hub laptop
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- Appendix: QR code files

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- 11. Account ownership and parish-held revenue
- 12. Split accounts, budget categories and payment account names

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